

THE
SEVENTH-DAY ADVENTIST
YEAR BOOK

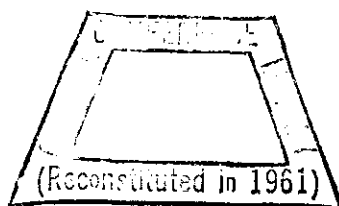
CONTAINING

STATISTICS OF THE GENERAL CONFERENCE AND OTHER
ORGANIZATIONS OF THE DENOMINATION, WITH
THE BUSINESS PROCEEDINGS OF THE

ANNIVERSARY MEETINGS

HELD AT BATTLE CREEK, MICHIGAN, NOV. 8-20, 1883.

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BATTLE CREEK, MICH.
SEVENTH-DAY ADVENTIST PUBLISHING ASSOCIATION.

1884.

PREFATORY.

THE publication of the "Year Book" for 1883 was so well received, and found to be so useful, that the General Conference at its last session unanimously voted that such a work should be published for 1884, and a committee of three was appointed for that purpose.

We much regret the delay in its issue. This has been caused chiefly by delay in some of the reports, the obtaining of addresses for the "Directories," and the almost unavoidable hindrances consequent in the preparation of a work of this kind.

A few changes have been made in the amount and character of its contents, from that of its predecessor, some of which are as follows: As almanacs are so common and easy of access, and as it costs so much more to prepare this kind of matter, the monthly tables have been omitted, and a one-page calendar for 1884 inserted. But though these calendars have been omitted, the number of pages will be more than in the edition of last year. The subject matter has also been placed in a more condensed form, and smaller type used, so that the book really contains much more than the book for 1883. If mistakes have not been made in historical dates, in addresses, or spelling of names, it is more than the Committee expect. It is no easy task to decide a matter where there seems equally good reason to decide two or more ways.

The new matter, we believe, will be of especial interest. The "Minister's Directory" will be of great use to our lay members, as well as to the various officers of our societies and ministers generally.

The "Historical Sketch" and the important and interesting tables will also be of great utility, as matters of reference. Our sincere wish is that the book may supply a long-felt want, fill well its place, and thus glorify God.

COMMITTEE.

CONTENTS.

	PAGE.
A Brief Sketch of the Origin and Progress of Seventh-day Adventists	5
Ministers' Directory	19
General Directories	22
General Conference Proceedings	30
International Tract and Missionary Society Proceedings	45
S. D. A. Publishing Association Proceedings	50
Pacific S. D. A. Publishing Association Proceedings	54
Proceedings of the S. D. A. Educational Society	55
Health Reform Institute	58
General Sabbath-School Association Proceedings	65
Proceedings of the American Health and Temperance Association	66
Constitution of the General Conference	68
Constitution for State Conferences	70
Revised Constitution of the International Tract and Missionary Society	72
Seventh-day Adventist Statistics, 1883	73
Important Events	74
The Publishing Work	76
Chronological Tables of Important Events	77
Accidents, etc., in 1883	79
Religious Denominations in the United States	79
Postal Guide	80
Population of the Principal Cities	3d p. of cover.

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Constitution of the General Conference	68
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SEVENTH-DAY ADVENTIST YEAR BOOK.



A BRIEF SKETCH OF THE ORIGIN AND PROGRESS OF SEVENTH-DAY ADVENTISTS.

OUR field of inquiry leads us back only to the great Advent movement of 1840-44. Respecting that movement it is presumed that the public are more or less informed; but they may not be so well aware of the causes which have led since that time to the rise of a class of people calling themselves Seventh-day Adventists.

Adventists looked for the end of the world in 1844, because it is said in Dan. 8:14, that at the end of the prophetic period of 2300 days the sanctuary should be cleansed. They believed those days would end in that year. They held that the earth was the sanctuary then to be cleansed, and that its cleansing was to be accomplished with fire, which would accompany the manifestation of the Lord from heaven. Hence they supposed the Lord would then come. There were, of course, many other facts and arguments in support of the view that the second coming of Christ was near, but what we have stated was the principal argument for fixing upon that particular time for the occurrence of the event.

The time passed, and the coming of Christ did not take place as was expected. It then became apparent that a mistake had been made in one or both of the following points: either the period of 2300 days did not end at that time, or the cleansing of the sanctuary was not to be the burning of the earth by fire at the second coming of Christ. While there was a possibility of their being mistaken on both these points, a mistake on either one would be sufficient to account for the fact that the Lord did not then appear.

A movement which had enlisted the whole interest of thousands upon thousands, would not, of course, be abandoned without reflection. The ground was looked over, and two methods adopted for explaining the disappointment. One class jumped to the conclusion at once that they were wrong on time, and the prophetic periods had not ended. Another class, on a careful survey of the whole field, impressed with the strength and harmony of the argument on chronology, saw no ground to change their views upon that point, but became satisfied that the mistake lay in the subject of the sanct-

uary and its cleansing. This class are the ones now known as Seventh-day Adventists. This brings us to note

THE DIFFERENCE

Between Seventh-day Adventists and First-day or No-day Adventists, as respects chronology. The latter, believing that the prophetic periods were given to make known the time of Christ's coming, and that they have not yet ended, are held to one of two conclusions; either that all that is said in the Bible about these periods is so much of revelation unrevealed, or else that the time of Christ's coming is to be known. The first conclusion, as consistent believers in the Bible, they cannot adopt, and hence their continual efforts to re-adjust the prophetic periods and fix upon the time for Christ to come. From this has arisen, in these latter years, all the fantastic time-setting which has very properly disgusted the world, and worse than this, has brought reproach on prophetic study. On the other hand,

SEVENTH-DAY ADVENTISTS SET NO TIME.

They do not believe that any prophetic period given in the Bible reaches to the coming of Christ, or was designed to mark the day or year of that event. As already noticed, they believe that the chronological argument of the great Advent movement of 1844 was all right, locating the termination of the longest prophetic period, the 2300 days, in the autumn of that year. The prophecy said that then the sanctuary should be cleansed. That sanctuary they found to be, not the earth, which is never so called, but the sanctuary of which Paul so fully and definitely treats in his epistle to the Hebrews, "the sanctuary" and "true tabernacle" in heaven, "which the Lord pitched and not man," of which Christ, our great High Priest, is minister while "on the throne of the Majesty in the heavens." Heb. 8:1, 2. The tabernacle erected by Moses in the wilderness of Sinai about 1500 years before Christ (Ex. 25 and onward), which was the sanctuary of the first covenant (Heb. 9:1), from that time till the first advent, was a type, figure, or pattern of this heavenly sanctuary of the new covenant. Heb. 9:9, 23, 24. The ministration of the sanctuary consisted of two grand divisions, which were accomplished every year; the daily ministration, and a brief service in the most holy place, or second apartment of the sanctuary, which completed the yearly round of service. This latter work was called the cleansing of the sanctuary, and was performed by the priest. So, likewise, the cleansing of the heavenly sanctuary (Heb. 9:23) must be performed by Christ while yet a priest, before he takes his kingdom and appears in his glory.

The view we take of the prophecy, consequently, is that the termination of the 2300 days in 1844 brought us to the commencement of this last portion of Christ's work as priest in the true tabernacle

above, called the cleansing of the sanctuary; not a cleansing from physical impurities, but from the presence of our sins, imparted to it through the blood of Christ there ministered in our behalf. This explains at once the mistake in 1844, and shows our present position. We are now in the time of the cleansing of the sanctuary,—a period of brief but indefinite duration, reaching to Christ's coming.

While, therefore, we do not throw away the prophetic periods, but believe they are to be understood, we believe also that they have been correctly interpreted, and have all terminated; so that now we have no data from which to reason respecting a definite time for the Lord to come.

THE SEVENTH DAY.

Two causes have operated to introduce the observance of the seventh-day Sabbath among Adventists, and thus to develop that class known as Seventh-day Adventists.

First, a Seventh-day Baptist sister, Mrs. Rachel D. Preston, from the State of New York, moved to Washington, N. H., where there was a church of Adventists. From them she received the doctrine of the soon-coming of Christ, and in return instructed them in reference to the claims of the fourth commandment of the decalogue. This was in 1844. Nearly that whole church immediately commenced the observance of the seventh day, and thus have the honor of being the first Seventh-day Adventist church in America. The ravages of death, and removals from the place, have considerably diminished their numbers; but the church there still lives to bear witness to the truth thus introduced among them.

The Sabbath question began immediately to be agitated among Adventists, and within a few months, many from their ranks commenced its observance. Among the earliest permanent converts to this doctrine, three deserve especial mention: 1. Eld. Joseph Bates, who with great zeal, devotion, and self-sacrifice, gave himself to its advocacy, and brought many to its observance. He fell asleep March 19, 1872, in the eightieth year of his age. 2. Eld. James White, the founder, and manager to the time of his decease, of the S. D. Adventist publishing work. He was for many years president of their five leading organizations; namely, The General Conference, The Publishing Association, The Health Reform Institute, The General Tract and Missionary Society, and the Educational Society. He died in Battle Creek, Mich., Aug. 6, 1881, aged 60 years. 3. Eld. J. N. Andrews, author of the "History of the Sabbath," the "Sanctuary," the "Three Messages," and other important works, and for many years a missionary to Switzerland in Europe. He died Oct. 21, 1883, in his fifty-fifth year.

Secondly, another cause which has tended to strengthen them in the observance of the seventh-day Sabbath, is the subject of the

sanctuary, to which we have already alluded. It was seen at once that the central object in the sanctuary, in whichever dispensation we view it, is the ark of God, which is enshrined in the most holy place of that heavenly building. This ark was prepared expressly as a receptacle for the tables of stone on which were written the great moral precepts of God's government, the ten commandments. Thus attention was called to the law of God. It was also seen that if the law in the ark of the heavenly sanctuary (Rev. 11:19) is the great original, and that deposited in the typical sanctuary was only a copy, or transcript, that law must read the same now as it read then, and the idea of any change is placed beyond the range of possibilities; that heaven and earth, as Christ in his first sermon declared, would sooner pass than one jot or tittle would pass from the law; and that the fourth commandment requires of the second house of Israel (spiritual Israel, or Christians) what it required of the first house (the literal descendants of Abraham), and has required from Eden down, the observance of the seventh day of the week as the grand and glorious memorial of our creation at the hands of God.

THEIR PUBLISHING WORK.

This, as already stated, originated through the instrumentality of Eld. James White. Eld. W. was born in Palmyra, Me., in 1821. Commencing at the age of twenty, he labored with much success as a public speaker in the great Advent movement of 1840-44, and when the claims of the Sabbath were brought to his notice, he entered as heartily into the work of its defense and promulgation. He began the work of publishing in 1849. In November, 1850, he commenced the publication of the *Advent Review and Sabbath Herald*, the organ of the S. D. Adventists.

To accommodate his publishing work to the field of his operations as a traveling evangelist, the paper was issued first at Paris, Me., till June, 1851, then at Saratoga Springs, N. Y., till March, 1852. It was then removed to Rochester, N. Y., where it continued nearly four years. Then, the cause of Sabbath reform rapidly advancing westward, its present location, Battle Creek, Mich., was selected as a more central position, and the paper was moved to this place in November, 1855. Up to this time, Eld. White was publisher and sole editor. Some of the time after this, others were associated with him on the editorial board.

The wants of the cause demanding an enlargement of operations, and the employment of more capital in the publishing business, an Act of the Legislature of Michigan for the Incorporation of Associations for Publishing Purposes, was secured and approved March 7, 1861. Under this Act, a legally incorporated association, under the name of The Seventh-day Adventist Publishing Association, was organized in Battle Creek, May 3, 1861. They immediately erected

a two-story brick building in the form of a Greek cross, the main portion 26x66, the transverse section 26x44, for the publishing work. In 1871 a second building of the same size and form was erected to meet the necessities of the increasing business. And in 1873 a third building of the same kind was built for the same purpose. In 1878 the first and third buildings were united by a four-story central structure, filling the whole space between them, making a large four-story building, with two three-story wings. In 1881 a large press-room, 46x66, was added to the right and rear. In these buildings we have an aggregate of thirty thousand square feet of floor space, which is occupied in the various branches of editing, printing, folding, book-binding, electrotyping, stereotyping, mailing, shipping, etc., furnished with the most modern machinery in all branches. Including all departments, it is the best-equipped printing office in the State of Michigan.

The different periodicals issued by the Association, the titles of which follow, have an aggregate monthly circulation of about 160,000 copies.

THE ADVENT REVIEW AND SABBATH HERALD, sixteen pages, weekly.

SIGNS OF THE TIMES, sixteen pages, weekly.

YOUTH'S INSTRUCTOR, an illustrated weekly.

SABBATH SENTINEL, monthly.

BIBLE-READING GAZETTE, monthly.

SANDHEDENS TIDENDE, Danish-Norwegian, semi-monthly.

SANNINGENS HAROLD, Swedish, monthly.

STIMME DER WAHRHEIT, German, monthly.

Books on the prophecies and other Bible subjects have been issued largely from the beginning, and have now reached an aggregate of two hundred and fifty millions of pages.

Nearly one hundred hands are regularly employed in the work, and the capital invested is over one hundred and fifty thousand dollars.

These results, wrought out in so short a time, are the only compliment that need be paid to him under whose management this degree of prosperity has been attained. Those acquainted with the business career of the late Eld. White, observed in him two strongly developed traits of character,—zeal to push forward in the formation and execution of plans for the advancement of the work, and caution to avoid injudicious and reckless ventures. The union of these two qualities made him master of the situation in the publishing line, and gave to the enterprise, though moving forward rapidly, a healthy and permanent growth.

THE WORK IN BATTLE CREEK.

The first meeting-house erected by S. D. Adventists in Battle Creek was in 1855. Its size was 18x24 feet. In 1857 a larger

house being needed, a building 28x44 was erected. This was speedily outgrown, so that a third house 40x65 with gallery was erected in 1867, capable of seating 600 persons. The necessity for a still larger house becoming apparent, in August, 1878, the last-named house was moved from its site on Washington St. fronting the public square, and the present tabernacle was commenced on the same location. The size of this building is 105x130. The main auditorium will seat 900 persons. This is surrounded by a north, an east, and a south vestry, seating respectively 250, 350, and 250 persons. These rooms are separated from the main auditorium by ground glass sliding partitions, which can all be raised when necessary, throwing the entire lower floor into one room, capable of seating at least 1,750 persons. A gallery running around three sides, seats 800; wall seats and chairs, 650 more; giving the entire building a seating capacity for 3,200 persons. The height of the central dome is 66 ft., clock tower, 108 ft. The arrangement of rooms described above adapts the house equally to large and small meetings, and makes it especially convenient for Sabbath-school work and inquiry meetings. It was dedicated April 20, 1879. Cost, about \$26,000. Architect, Henry T. Brush, Detroit, Mich.

THEIR ORGANIZATION.

This is exceedingly simple. A body of believers associate together, taking the name of Seventh-day Adventists, and attaching their names to a covenant simply to keep the commandments of God and the faith of Jesus. The Bible is their only creed. A clerk is chosen to keep the records of the church, and an elder, elected by vote of the church, is ordained to look after its spiritual interests. If the church is large, its temporal affairs are assigned to one or more deacons, chosen by vote of the church for this purpose. They hold that the terms, elder, bishop, and pastor, (Greek, *επισκοπος*, *ἐπίσκοπος*, and *ποιμήν*), signify the same officer, which is a local officer, confined to a particular church. These need not be ordained ministers. Evangelists (*εὐαγγελισταί*) are ordained ministers, who travel from place to place to preach the gospel, and are the only ones competent to ordain local elders and deacons.

NUMBERS.

They now number 680 churches, with an enrollment of 17,436 members, according to the returns made to the General Conference of Nov. 8, 1883. But owing to the scattered condition of this people, a large proportion of them are not so situated as to belong to any of the church organizations, single families being scattered all the way from Maine to California and Oregon, in all the Northern States, and in many of the Southern. The whole number is estimated at from twenty to twenty-five thousand. The number of or-

dained ministers is 165; licentiates, 135. None of the churches have pastors stationed with them. They maintain their worship without the aid of a preacher, only as one may occasionally visit them, leaving the ministers free to devote almost their whole time to carrying these views to those who have never before heard him. During the summer months, they carry forward their work by means of large tents 40 to 60 feet in diameter. About eighty of these were in use during the summer of 1883.

CONFERENCES.

The next advance in organization from single churches, is the State Conference. The churches in a State combine to form a State Conference, adopting a constitution to regulate their action. All the ministers in the State, are, by virtue of their office, members of the State Conference, and each church is entitled to delegates according to its membership. At each annual meeting an executive committee of three is elected by vote of the delegates, of whom the president of the Conference is chairman. This committee have supervision of all the ministerial and religious work of the Conference between the yearly meetings, and appoint the delegates to the General Conference.

S. D. Adventists now have twenty-eight State Conferences as follows: Maine, New England (including in this division only New Hampshire, Massachusetts, Rhode Island, and Connecticut), Vermont, New York, Pennsylvania, Ohio, Michigan, Indiana, Illinois, Wisconsin, Minnesota, Iowa, Nebraska, Dakota, Missouri, Kentucky, Tennessee, Kansas, Colorado, Texas, California, Oregon, Virginia, Upper Columbia, Province of Quebec, Denmark, Suisse, and Sweden.

The next outward sweep from the State Conference is the General Conference. This is composed of delegates, ministers, or laymen from all the State Conferences. This Conference also annually elects its executive committee of five, to have charge of the doings of the denomination in all parts of the field. The president of the General Conference is the highest officer in the body. The object of the General Conference is to unify the work in all localities, equalize labor, and supply destitute fields with help. The meeting of the General Conference held in Battle Creek, Mich., Nov. 8-20, 1883, was its twenty-second annual session.

FUNDS.

Means to sustain the work is raised by a plan denominated the tithing system, founded on the instructions of Paul in 1 Cor. 16:2. By this system it is designed that every one shall, upon each first day of the week, lay by a sum equal, as near as may be, to one-tenth of his income from whatever source. There is nothing compulsory

in this matter, yet all this people, with few exceptions, have adopted, and are acting upon, this plan. According to this system, contributions being proportioned to the amount of property one possesses, or the strength and ability with which he is blessed for acquiring, none are burdened. It treats the rich and poor alike, in proportion to their ability, while a steady stream is thus poured into the treasury. For the year 1883, the amount raised in this manner in all the Conferences was over ninety-six thousand dollars.

Each church appoints its collector and treasurer, who once a month, or in rural districts once a quarter, gather up these contributions. With the exception of a small percentage retained by some of the churches for their own use, these funds are sent by the church treasurers to the State Conference Treasurer. At each yearly meeting of the Conference, an auditing committee is appointed, which examines the accounts of all the ministers in the employ of the Conference, and settles with each one according to the amount of labor performed. One-tenth of all the funds coming into the State treasury is voted to the General Conference, which is then put into the hands of the General Conference Treasurer, to be expended under the direction of the General Conference Committee.

It is also the plan that all the different institutions connected with this cause, pay a tenth of their income into the General Conference Treasury.

THE HEALTH AND TEMPERANCE REFORM.

The attention of S. D. Adventists was called to the subject of Christian Temperance chiefly through the labors of Eld. and Mrs. White. At the outset of their public labors they took a strong stand against the common use of tobacco and other narcotics, as well as against the use of alcoholic liquors. Eld. Joseph Bates, who was one of the earliest temperance reformers in the country, having assisted in the organization of the first temperance society in America, was associated with them in this work.

In 1862, chiefly through the writings of Eld. and Mrs. White, a more thorough-going reform was inaugurated. It was urged that a person's moral nature is largely affected by his physical condition. It was therefore seen that success in appealing to man's higher and spiritual nature is much more certain if he can be turned from wrong habits of life, which undermine the physical and benumb the moral powers.

At the present time the whole body of S. D. Adventists are abstainers from the use of alcoholic drinks of all kinds. Tobacco, in all its forms, is also discarded, none addicted to its use being received into the churches except upon the promise and expectation of its immediate abandonment. The result is, that, as a denomination, the sight and scent of tobacco are not found among this people.

Pork, tea, and coffee are also discarded. Rich and highly seasoned food is little used. Grease and spices are seldom employed in cookery. Flesh food is used much less freely than by people generally. Two meals only a day are considered preferable for most people, those to be composed chiefly of grains, fruits, and vegetables, served, however, in a great variety of palatable and wholesome forms.

These reformatory ideas, with the exception of those respecting alcohol and tobacco, are not made tests of fellowship, but a strong effort is made to impress them upon the people in such a manner as to secure attention to them. For the purpose of keeping them constantly before the members of the denomination, a society was organized Jan. 1, 1880, known as the "American Health and Temperance Association," which requires its members to sign one of the following pledges:—

TEETOTAL PLEDGE.—I do hereby solemnly affirm that with the help of God I will wholly abstain from the voluntary use, as a beverage or in any equivalent manner, of alcohol, tea, and coffee, and from the use of tobacco, opium, and all other narcotics and stimulants.

ANTI-RUM AND TOBACCO PLEDGE.—I do hereby solemnly affirm that with the help of God I will wholly abstain from the voluntary use of alcohol in any form, as a beverage or in any equivalent manner, and from smoking, chewing, or snuffing tobacco, or using it in any other form, and from in any way encouraging the use of these poisons.

ANTI-WHISKY PLEDGE.—I do hereby solemnly affirm that with the help of God I will totally abstain from the voluntary use, as a beverage or in any equivalent manner, of all liquids or substances containing alcohol.

It is expected that every member of the denomination will sign the teetotal pledge. Those who do not at first, are soon willing to do so. The Association has subsidiary State societies and local clubs in nearly all parts of the United States, with a total membership of about 20,000.

This reform ends not with diet alone, but extends to all other habits of life; and as the health of the body is affected, to a great extent, by the manner in which it is clothed, that subject occupies a prominent place in this reform. The fashionable female attire of the present day is held to be chargeable with at least three leading evils as related to health: First, hanging burdens upon the body in an unnatural manner; secondly, hindering the full play of the vital organs; thirdly, insufficiently protecting the extremities. It is therefore recommended to shorten the skirt till it fully clears the filth and obstructions of the street, fit the garments loosely around the waist, suspend them from the shoulders, and thoroughly protect the limbs. Special attention is paid to personal cleanliness, the sanitary condition of dwellings, and to all matters relating to health.

For the purpose of inculcating the principles of this reform and for the introduction of improved methods of medical treatment, especially for chronic invalids, the "Health Reform Institute" was founded Sept. 5, 1866. The institution was legally incorporated April 6, 1867.

Stock was raised to the amount of \$26,000, which has since been increased to about \$37,000. No dividends are rendered to stock-

holders, as they have released their claim upon profits, to enable the earnings of the institution to be devoted to the treatment of worthy poor persons and the provision of additional facilities as needed.

Increasing patronage demanding more facilities, a large building 120x136 feet, four stories in height above the basement, was erected, and opened for patients April 10, 1878. It is provided with an elevator, and all modern improvements for the convenience and comfort of patients. It is heated with steam, and lighted with gas. Cost, about eighty thousand dollars. Besides this, the old main building and five cottages are owned by the institution, which is now known as the Medical and Surgical Sanitarium.

The increasing patronage of the institution has made it necessary to rent nine additional buildings for the accommodation of patients; and during the last season even these have become inadequate to accommodate those coming for treatment, which has led the managers to take steps for the erection of a large addition to the present main building during the present season, which will more than double its capacity for accommodating the sick. At the date of this writing the main buildings of the institution are filled to their utmost capacity, and it is impossible to accommodate satisfactorily and comfortably new patients who are daily arriving. The expense of the new building will be met by the issue of new stock, the larger portion of which is already subscribed.

The Sanitarium, though founded and managed by S. D. Adventists, is not conducted on a sectarian basis. But a small proportion of its patrons are members of the denomination. Members of all denominations, and all respectable people, are made equally welcome. A high moral tone is preserved in the management of the institution.

A monthly magazine, formerly known as the *Health Reformer*, now called *Good Health*, was started in 1866. It is devoted to the consideration of all subjects pertaining to health, and to mental, moral, and physical culture. It has for years enjoyed the largest circulation of any health journal in the country. It is wholly undenominational in character.

MISSIONARY OPERATIONS.

Public speakers being few, in comparison with the calls for labor, a plan has been adopted which gives to all an opportunity to act some part in the promulgation of our views. This consists in an organization called the Tract and Missionary Society.

In this organization, the State is divided into districts, each district being composed of a certain number of churches adjacent to each other. For each district a director is appointed, who appoints a librarian for each church in his district, to take charge of distributing tracts to the members, and a district secretary to keep an account of the whole working of the district. The district directors, a president, secretary, and treasurer, constitute the officers of each

State T. and M. Society. Such societies have now been organized in each of the twenty-eight State Conferences. Partial organizations have also been effected in Europe where missions have been established.

These State and foreign Societies then unite and form a General Tract and Missionary Society, with its proper officers, the name of which was changed at the General Conference of 1882 to that of "International Tract and Missionary Society."

The object of this organization is to systematically canvass the country with books, tracts, and pamphlets, setting forth the things we hold to be special truths for this time, to obtain subscribers for our various periodicals, visit the sick, call upon, and converse and pray with, families and individuals; and the general organization is designed to seek out openings and supply calls for help in all the world.

Although of recent organization, two hundred and fifty thousand dollars have been employed in carrying forward this work. Thousands of volumes, largely bound books, have been placed in public libraries, on board vessels, etc. The reports for the past year show a distribution of over nine million pages of reading matter, besides over six hundred thousand periodicals. Publications during this time have been sent through the mail and otherwise to all civilized countries, more than thirty-three thousand letters have been written, and over sixty-six thousand families visited.

IN OTHER TONGUES.

Missions are now in successful operation among the Danes, Norwegians, Swedes, Germans, and French in this country. The Danish, Swedish, and German papers have already been noticed. Our full catalogue of the publications issued at this Office now embraces forty-four different works in Danish, twenty-three in Swedish, fifteen in French, thirty-one in German, and one in the Holland language, besides the two periodicals in the Danish and Swedish languages. A good beginning is thus made in the occupation of the field assigned to this message, which is to go to "many peoples, nations, tongues, and kings."

Our views have also gained a permanent foothold in England, Switzerland, France, Denmark, Norway, Sweden; Germany, Italy, and Roumania in Europe, and in Egypt in Africa. There are now some six hundred believers in these countries. Sept. 15, 1874, Eld. J. N. Andrews left this country for that field of labor. Dec. 25, 1875, Eld. D. T. Bourdeau left his work in America to join Eld. Andrews in the European mission field, where he arrived Jan. 7, 1876, and remained two years, returning again to France Sept. 4, 1883. Nov. 17, 1877, three others went from America to assist Eld. Andrews in the work in Europe. June 28, 1883, Eld. B. L. Whitney and family, and three others, sailed as co-laborers in Switzerland.

In July, 1876, the publication of a paper in French was commenced at Bâle, Switzerland. The paper, called *Les Signes des Temps*, is a large eight-pags sheet, and is issued monthly. Periodicals in the German, Italian, and Roumanian languages are now being published.

Eld. J. Ertzenberger, of Switzerland, having visited this country to learn our views more perfectly, is now laboring successfully in Germany.

In May, 1877, Eld. J. G. Matteson sailed from this country to his native land, Denmark, to open a mission there. He reports one hundred and forty-one who have embraced S. D. Adventist views as the result of his labors. He is now successfully publishing tracts and pamphlets, and regularly issues three periodicals in Danish-Norwegian, at Christiana, Norway. Elds. E. G. Olsen and A. B. Oyen are now preparing to go to Norway to co-operate with Eld. J. G. Matteson.

Dec. 17, 1878, Eld. J. N. Loughborough, having closed his labors in California, sailed from New York to establish a mission in England. Dec. 30, he commenced work in Southampton, where he found many interested hearers and readers. Jan. 9, 1882, Eld. A. A. John and others left this country to assist Eld. L. in his promising field of labor. It is also expected that two others, Elds. J. H. Durland and M. C. Wilcox, will sail for England as missionaries in February, 1884.

Sabbath-keepers have also been discovered in Holland, Hungary, Russia, and Turkey.

CAMP-MEETINGS.

The first camp-meeting of S. D. Adventists was held, under the management of Elds. White and Andrews, in the town of Wright, Mich., Sept. 1-7, 1868. The results of this meeting were so encouraging that the plan of holding meetings of this kind during the summer months was soon generally adopted among this people.

The past season (1883), five camp-meetings were held in Michigan, four in Kansas, three in Iowa, two in Wisconsin, two in Indiana, one in Alabama, and one each in nineteen other conferences, making thirty-six in all.

These meetings, as conducted by S. D. Adventists, are designed to be occasions of great spiritual profit to all who attend, promoting a revival spirit, and deep and vital piety. Complete order is maintained, proper hours for rest are secured, and everything passes off with as much order and decorum as would be observed in a house of worship. Michigan owns a large tent, 80x120 feet, which is used at camp-meetings in that State. A similar tent, 80x125 feet, is owned by the New England Conference, and is used in its yearly camp-meetings. Tents nearly as large are owned by most of the State conferences.

THE PACIFIC COAST.

In 1868 Elds. J. N. Loughborough and D. T. Bourdeau were sent by the General Conference on a mission to California, and, with a large tent taken with them, commenced the work. From this point the cause of Seventh-day Adventism has grown quite rapidly on that coast. In 1872 Eld. White and wife visited that State, and aided in organizing a State Conference. They again visited California in the latter part of 1873, remaining until August, 1874. On this last visit, perceiving that the growing cause in that distant locality needed a medium of communication nearer than the publishing house in Michigan, Eld. W. commenced in Oakland, Cal., the publication of *The Signs of the Times*, the first number of which was issued June 4, 1874. It was started as a weekly, the same as the *Review and Herald*. The wants of the cause, and the action of the General Conference of Aug. 10, 1874, calling Bro. W. east, the California Conference assumed the publication of the *Signs*. At their camp-meeting at Yountville, Oct. 1-12, 1874, nineteen thousand dollars was pledged for the purpose of establishing a publishing office, which has since been paid.

April 5, 1875, an association, called the Pacific Seventh-day Adventist Publishing Association, was incorporated to carry forward the publishing work there. The *Signs*, used as a pioneer paper by the various Tract and Missionary Societies, is very widely circulated. That office is now furnished with six power presses, and a full assortment of book-binding, electrotyping, and other necessary machinery.

In 1882 a sanitarium known as "Rural Health Retreat" was opened in St. Helena, Cal. The modes of treatment are the same as those in use in the Sanitarium at Battle Creek, Mich.

The same year a school was organized at Healdsburg, under the name of "Healdsburg Academy." Shortly after, it was incorporated into a college, stock was issued, and a regular board of trustees elected. The College has a full corps of competent instructors. The courses are five in number; viz., Initial, Grammar, Scientific, Biblical, and Classical. The object of the school, like that of the one at Battle Creek, is to provide a place where the youth can be protected from the infidelity, vice, and immorality so prevalent in many schools at the present day, and to fit them for useful labor in the cause of God. Manual labor is to a certain extent connected with the school, that the physical powers of the student may be developed and preserved, thus forming a good foundation for a sound, vigorous intellect. The strictest discipline is maintained.

There are now over fifteen hundred S. D. Adventists on the Pacific coast. A Conference embracing Oregon and Washington Territory, called the North Pacific Conference, was organized in

1879. From this, another Conference was formed in 1880, called the Upper Columbia Conference. The influence of these is extending to adjoining Territories, and Sabbath-keepers are now found in Idaho, Nevada, Utah, and Arizona. — *Yearbook, 1884*

THE EDUCATIONAL SOCIETY.

The subject of education began to receive attention among S. D. Adventists as early as 1872. In March, 1874, an association called the S. D. Adventist Educational Society, was incorporated. A large and convenient building was erected, and a college organized in Battle Creek, Mich., which was opened for students in January, 1875, and now has a yearly attendance of between three and four hundred. Six departments are maintained; namely, Primary, Normal, Missionary, Commercial, Biblical, and Scientific. There are seven courses of study, as follows: the Minim, two Preparatory (English and Classical), Teachers', Special, English, and Classical. Expenses are brought within the small compass of \$125 per year, including everything necessary. The design of the Board and Faculty is to maintain the most correct standard of discipline and morals; and this has so far been successfully carried out. This school is coming to be regarded, wherever known, as a most desirable place at which to obtain an education. A good beginning has been made in the way of a library, chemical and philosophical apparatus, geological specimens, a museum, etc.; and the interest among its friends and patrons is increasing.

The site of the College is a beautiful plot of twelve acres, in the highest part of the city, opposite the grounds of the Sanitarium. The building is of brick, 37x71, with two hall wings, each 17x37, three stories high, and is capable of accommodating between four and five hundred students.

Schools have been founded in different State conferences, notably among which is the one at South Lancaster, Mass. Manual labor as connected with this school is a prominent feature of this enterprise. The useful arts and trades are taught to both sexes. The success which has attended this school during the brief period it has been in progress, speaks well for the instructors and trustees, especially in a religious point of view, and in the development of laborers for the cause of God. Steps have recently been taken for the erection of a larger and more suitable building, to be known as the South Lancaster Academy.



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[When a minister's address is outside of the State under which his name is found, the State is given].

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DAKOTA.—*Executive Committee*, Eld. A. D. Olsen, *President*, Howard, D. T.; Eld. S. B. Whitney, Bridgewater, D. T.; Eld. M. M. Olsen, Madison, D. T.; *Secretary*, Vesta J. Olsen, Howard, D. T.

ILLINOIS.—*President*, Eld. R. F. Andrews, Onarga, Ill.; *Vice-President*, Eld. J. F. Ballenger, Ridott, Ill.; *Secretary*, Lizzie S. Campbell, Belvidere, Ill.

INDIANA.—*Executive Committee*, Eld. J. M. Rees, Kokomo, Ind.; Eld. J. W. Covert; W. R. Carpenter; *Secretary*, Leanna Morrell, Ligonier, Ind.

IOWA.—*Executive Committee*, Eld. J. H. Durland, *President*, Forest City, Io.; R. C. Porter, Danbury, Io.; J. B. Hodges, Sandyville, Io.; *Secretary*, P. A. Holly, State Center, Io.

KANSAS.—*Executive Committee*, Eld. M. Enoch, *President*, Bull City, Kan.; Eld. G. H. Rogers; G. H. Smith; *Secretary*, Emma Enoch, Bull City, Kan.

KENTUCKY.—*President*, Green Trent, Custer, Ky.; *Vice-President*, William Garret; *Secretary*, Sallie Branstetter, Nolin, Ky.

MAINE.—*Executive Committee*, Eld. S. J. Hersum, *President*, Deering, Me.; Eld. R. S. Wsbbber; R. J. Baker; *Secretary*, Mrs. A. K. Hersum, Deering, Me.

MICHIGAN.—*President*, Eld. M. B. Miller, Battle Creek, Mich.; *Vice-President*, Eld. William Ostrander, Elmwood, Mich.; *Secretary*, Eva Bell Giles, Battle Creek, Mich.

MINNESOTA.—*President*, Eld. J. Fulton, Hutchinson, Minn.; *Vice-President*, W. B. White, Medford, Minn.; *Secretary*, E. S. Babcock, Cleveland, Minn.

*MISSOURI.—*Executive Committee*, Eld. D. T. Jones, *President*, Kingsville, Mo.; Eld. J. G. Wood; C. H. Chafee; *Secretary*, Joseph Clark, Lowry City, Mo.

NEBRASKA.—*Executive Committee*, Eld. George B. Starr, *President*, Fremont, Neb.; Eld. D. Nettleton; Eld. O. A. Johnson, Calhoun; *Secretary*, Mrs. Annie E. Shepherd, Nebraska City, Neb.

NEW ENGLAND.—*Executive Committee*, E. P. Farnsworth, *President*, South Lancaster, Mass.; Eld. D. A. Robinson; O. O. Farnsworth; *Secretary*, Mrs. E. D. Robinson, South Lancaster, Mass.

NEW YORK.—*Executive Committee*, Eld. M. H. Brown, *President*, Watertown, N. Y.; Eld. G. W. Bliss; Eld. E. E. Miles; *Secretary*, Mrs. N. J. Walsworth, No. 2 Cherry St., Syracuse, N. Y.

NORTH PACIFIC.—*Executive Committee*, Eld. C. L. Boyd, *President*, East Portland, Or.; W. P. Wilson; Henry Aitkins; *Secretary*, R. D. Benham, Salem, Or.

OHIO.—*Executive Committee*, Eld. G. G. Rupert, *President*, East Norwalk, O.; Mrs. M. E. Guilford; G. W. Angleberger; *Secretary*, Verna Null, Delaware, O.

PENNSYLVANIA.—*Executive Committee*, Eld. F. Peabody, *President*, West Valley, N. Y.; Eld. J. G. Saunders; Eld. J. E. Robinson; *Secretary*, Mrs. F. C. Oviatt, Wellsville, N. Y.

TENNESSEE.—*Executive Committee*, W. D. Dortch, *President*, Springville, Henry Co., Tenn.; W. L. Esken, Leach, Tenn.; *Secretary*, J. E. White, Cross Plains, Robertson Co., Tenn.

TEXAS.—*Executive Committee*, H. C. Chrisman, †*President*; W. J. Keer; Frank Green; *Secretary*, Susie C. King, Dallas, Texas.

UPPER COLUMBIA.—*Secretary*, Mrs. M. O. Beck, Milton, Or.

*VERMONT.—*Executive Committee*, H. Peebles, *President*, South Lunenburg, Vt.; H. W. Pierce; R. S. Owen; *Secretary*, Ann E. Smith, Troy, Vt.

*As given last year.

† Address not known.

VIRGINIA.—*Executive Committee*, R. D. Hottel, *President*, Quicksburg, Va.; W. W. Stebbins; M. G. Huffman; *Secretary*, Lillie D. Woods, New Market, Shenandoah Co., Va.

WISCONSIN.—*Executive Committee*, Eld. A. D. Olsen, *President*, Howard, D. T.; Eld. G. C. Tenney; Eld. S. S. Smith; *Secretary*, Nellie C. Taylor, Neillsville, Clarke Co., Wis.

HEALTH AND TEMPERANCE SOCIETY.

* CALIFORNIA.—*President*, Dr. E. J. Waggoner, Healdsburg, Cal.; *Vice-President*, C. H. Jones, Oakland, Cal.; † *Secretary*, Eld. G. D. Ballou, Oakland, Cal.

* ILLINOIS.—*President*, Eld. R. F. Andrews, Onarga, Ill.; *Secretary*, Ida W. Ballenger, Winslow, Ill.

* IOWA.—*President*, Eld. L. McCoy, Sigourney, Iowa; *Secretary*, S. N. Hodges, Sigourney, Iowa.

KANSAS.—*President*, Eld. G. H. Rogers, Air, Kan.; *Secretary*, Lettie A. Miller, Topeka, Kan.

MAINE.—*President*, Eld. R. S. Webber, Richmond, Me.; *Secretary*, M. B. Patterson, Dresden, Me.

* MICHIGAN.—*President*, Eld. H. M. Kenyon, Allegan, Mich.; *Secretary*, Nellie Sisley Starr, Battle Creek, Mich.

* MISSOURI.—*President*, Eld. J. G. Wood, Appleton City, Mo.; *Secretary*, Joseph Clark, Lowry City, Mo.

NEW YORK.—*President*, Eld. E. W. Whitney, Rome, N. Y.; *Secretary*, Mrs. E. W. Whitney, Rome, N. Y.

NEW ENGLAND.—*President*, Eld. D. A. Robinson, South Lancaster, Mass.; *Secretary*, Mrs. D. A. Robinson, South Lancaster, Mass.

NEBRASKA.—*President*, Eld. Geo. B. Starr, Fremont, Neb.; *Secretary*, James Stanton, Ravenna, Neb.

* OHIO.—*President*, D. E. Lindsay, Cardington, O.; *Secretary*, E. J. Van Horn, Clyde, O.

* PENNSYLVANIA.—*President*, Eld. D. T. Fero, Ellicottville, Catt. Co., N. Y.; *Secretary*, Mrs. L. A. Fero, Ellicottville, N. Y.

TEXAS.—*President*, J. F. Bahler, Denison, Texas; *Secretary*, Mrs. M. J. Bahler, Denison, Texas.

* WISCONSIN.—*President*, Eld. G. C. Tenney, Milton, Rock Co., Wis.; *Secretary*, Mary F. Stillman, Madison, Wis.

* As given last year. † The Secretaries of the H. and T. Societies are also the Treasurers.

GENERAL CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS.

TWENTY-SECOND ANNUAL SESSION.

The Conference assembled according to appointment, at the Tabernacle in Battle Creek, Mich., Nov. 8, 1883, at 9 A. M., the President, Eld. Geo. I. Butler, in the chair. Prayer was offered by Eld. S. N. Haskell.

Proceeding to an organization, the following were received as delegates upon presentation of credentials from their respective

conferences : California, S. N. Haskell, W. C. White, J. D. Rice ; Colorado, E. R. Jones ; Dakota, A. D. Olsen ; Illinois, R. F. Andrews, T. M. Steward ; Indiana, S. H. Lane, Wm. Covert ; Iowa, E. W. Farnsworth, H. Nicola, A. R. Henry ; Kansas, J. H. Cook, Oscar Hill ; Kentucky, M. B. Miller ; Maine, J. B. Goodrich ; Michigan, U. Smith, J. Fargo, I. D. Van Horn, E. H. Root, M. B. Miller, W. H. Littlejohn, H. M. Kenyon, Wm. Ostrander ; Minnesota, O. A. Olsen, H. Grant, J. Fulton ; Missouri, D. T. Jones, J. G. Wood ; Nebraska, A. J. Cudney, O. A. Johnson ; New England, D. A. Robinson, C. W. Comings ; New York, M. H. Brown, E. W. Whitney ; Ohio, H. A. St. John, E. H. Gates, R. A. Underwood ; Pennsylvania, D. B. Oviatt, F. Peabody ; Tennessee, S. Fulton ; Texas, R. M. Kilgore ; Vermont, A. S. Hutchins ; Wisconsin, H. W. Decker, E. E. Olive ; English Mission, J. N. Loughborough ; South Atlantic Mission, J. O. Corliss.

The following were by vote delegated to represent their different fields, some of the conferences named not having chosen their full quota : Canada, R. S. Owen ; Denmark and Sweden, J. P. Rosqvist ; Indiana, J. P. Henderson ; Kansas, Geo. Smith ; Nebraska, Geo. B. Starr ; New York, Geo. W. Bliss ; North Pacific and Upper Columbia, W. C. White ; Vermont, H. W. Pierce ; Wisconsin, J. F. Hanson.

On motion of Eld. J. O. Corliss, the Virginia Conference, which was fully organized last March, with a membership of eighty-six, was received as a member of the General Conference, and Eld. A. C. Neff was admitted as its delegate upon presentation of his credentials.

The organization of the Conference being effected, the President then delivered the opening address, giving a retrospective view of the condition and wants of the cause in the different fields of labor. A rising interest is felt among our people in our foreign missions and the general work, which has been shown by the liberality of the brethren in pledging the past season for the support of the European, English, and Scandinavian missions, and the International T. and M. Society. Elds. B. L. Whitney and D. T. Bourdeau, with their families, have gone to Europe to assist in the European mission ; and although the recent death of Eld. J. N. Andrews is a sad blow to the work, yet encouraging reports are being received of the condition of the cause there. A German paper is greatly needed, and also a paper in England. The Italian brethren are also calling for a paper, even if not more than a quarterly. The matter of enlarging the printing operations in Switzerland must be considered at this meeting, also the question of furnishing Eld. Matteson the proper help in his work. A mission should also be established in Australia, and we should be turning our attention to the islands of the Pacific, so that the truth may engirdle the whole earth.

The question of establishing missions in the large cities of our own country should be considered still further at this Conference. One has been established in New York, another in San Francisco, and others should be opened at other large places.

Calls for labor are coming in from different parts. There are many good openings, but where are the men who in the fear of God, and with the salvation of souls in view, will answer these calls for help?

The camp-meetings of the past season show a rising interest among the people all through the field, and a willingness to help in the work. The bitter opposition waged against us this year is another source of encouragement. The opposition on the subject of spiritual gifts has created a great interest on that subject, and we should be preparing by the publication of suitable works, to meet a still greater opposition in this direction in the near future.

On motion, the reading of the minutes of the last session was waived. The Chair being empowered to appoint the standing committees, they were announced as follows: On Nominations, H. W. Decker, A. J. Cudney, D. A. Robinson; on Resolutions, U. Smith, J. N. Loughborough, E. W. Farnsworth, W. C. White, O. A. Olsen; on Credentials and Licenses, J. N. Loughborough, J. O. Corliss, I. D. Van Horn; on Auditing, J. B. Goodrich, A. R. Henry, C. W. Comings, W. C. White, S. H. Lane, R. M. Kilgore.

Voted, That the Chair appoint a committee of three to act with the General Conference Committee in considering the wants of destitute fields. The Chair appointed the following: W. H. Littlejohn, A. S. Hutchins, D. B. Oviatt.

Voted, That the Chair appoint a committee on arrangements, to consist of three persons. J. Fargo, W. C. White, and J. O. Corliss were announced as this committee.

Reports from missionaries being called for, Eld. J. O. Corliss gave a statement of the condition and wants of the South Atlantic mission. There are in this mission two hundred and sixty-seven white Sabbath-keepers and twenty colored. One or two laborers are needed there to forward the work.

On motion, the Conference adjourned to six o'clock the same evening.

SECOND MEETING, NOV. 8, AT 6 P. M.—Prayer by U. Smith. Dr. W. D. Stillman, delegate from Wisconsin, and Eld. A. O. Burrill, delegate from Michigan, presented their credentials at this meeting. It was voted that W. J. Boynton represent the New York mission, A. W. Bartlett the work in Florida, R. Conradi the German work, and that M. C. Wilcox be chosen as the fourth member of the New York delegation.

Several of the presidents of the State conferences had prepared

maps of their respective conferences, showing by the use of red and blue dots where the organized and unorganized bodies of Seventh-day Adventists are situated. Some of these maps were hung up before the Conference, and interesting facts and figures were given, showing the standing of the conferences, the amount of territory occupied, and the vast amount of work yet to be done before all shall have heard the message of truth. Truly, "the harvest is great, but the laborers are few."

The meeting then adjourned till 9 A. M., Nov. 9.

THIRD MEETING, NOV. 9, AT 9 A. M.—Prayer by A. S. Hutchins. The fourth delegate from Iowa, Eld. C. A. Washburn, took his seat in the Conference at this meeting.

The subject of the foreign missions being introduced, Eld. J. N. Loughborough, lately returned from England, spoke of the condition and wants of the English mission, and gave many interesting details in regard to the obstacles the work there has had to meet, the methods of labor employed, and the results obtained in different parts. After this, Eld. J. P. Rosqvist, a Swedish brother who has recently arrived from Sweden, gave an account of the rise, progress, and present condition of the work in Sweden, showing how the Lord oftentimes uses the opposition and hatred of the evil one to advance the cause of truth. There are many openings in this country for preaching the truth, but laborers and help are greatly needed.

After some responsive remarks from the President, the meeting adjourned to call of Chair.

FOURTH MEETING, NOV. 9, AT 3 P. M.—After prayer by H. W. Decker, the minutes of the previous meeting were read and approved. At the last annual session of the Conference, it was recommended that a manual of instructions to church officers be prepared, and a committee was appointed to consider the matter and report at this session. W. H. Littlejohn, the chairman of the committee, reported at this meeting that the committee had prepared a series of articles, containing instructions to church officers, which have been printed in the *Review* under the title, "The Church Manual." It was thought best to print them in the *Review* first, in order to give opportunity for examination and criticism before the matter should come up for final action at this session. After further remarks upon the subject by Elds. S. N. Haskell, Geo. I. Butler, H. A. St. John, and Bro. W. C. White, it was—

Voted, That the Chair appoint a committee of ten to act with the General Conference Committee in the examination and consideration of "The Church Manual." This committee was announced as follows: W. C. White, H. Nicola, J. H. Cook, S. H. Lane, O. A. Olsen, M. H. Brown, R. F. Andrews, J. B. Goodrich, A. S. Hutchins, H. W. Decker.

The Committee on Resolutions then made a partial report, of which the following resolutions, after being discussed and amended as given below, were adopted :—

1. *Whereas*, Our beloved brother and faithful missionary, Eld. J. N. Andrews, was removed by death in Bale, Suisse, Oct. 21, 1883; therefore—

Resolved, That we hereby express our appreciation of his earnest, faithful, and self-sacrificing labors. And while our hearts are bowed in grief, and we deeply feel the loss this cause sustains in being deprived of his counsel, his painstaking and careful research (which has resulted in the production of such invaluable works as "History of the Sabbath"), and the benefits of his literary ability, we would not murmur at this painful dispensation of Providence, believing that of him it can be especially said that he rests from his labors and his works do follow him. And we hereby tender our warmest sympathy to his aged mother, to Charles, his only surviving child, and to his co-laborers in the European mission.

2. *Resolved*, That we recognize the necessity of publishing in Europe, papers in the English, German, Italian, and Swedish languages; and we hereby recommend the Conference Committee to arrange for such publication at the earliest possible opportunity.

3. *Whereas*, The Year Book of 1883 has been received with general favor, and has seemed to satisfactorily meet the object of its publication; therefore—

Resolved, That we recommend the publication of such a work each year, and that, in addition to such matter as appeared in the first number, it also contain a full list of the names of all our ministers, with their post-office addresses, and a brief history of the rise and progress of our work, especially noticing the operations and progress of the current year.

The first resolution was also adopted by a rising vote of the congregation. With reference to the third resolution, it was—

Voted, That the matter of preparing the Year Book for 1884 be assigned to a committee of three, to be appointed by the Chair. The Chair appointed W. H. Littlejohn, H. A. St. John, and M. C. Wilcox.

Adjourned to call of Chair.

FIFTH MEETING, NOV. 11, AT 3 P. M.—The report of the Committee on Resolutions was considered still further at this meeting, and the remainder of the resolutions were adopted as given below :—

4. *Whereas*, There has been great call for the publication in pamphlet form of the articles written by Bro. Andrews some years ago, on the "Order of Events in the Judgment"; therefore—

Resolved, That we recommend that the same be revised by Bro. U. Smith, and published as requested.

5. *Whereas*, There is a prevailing desire among our people to know more of the facts connected with the manifestation of the spirit of prophecy in our midst; therefore—

Resolved, That we recommend that this Conference select a suitable person, or persons, to prepare a work setting forth such facts for the use of our own people and the information of the public generally.

6. *Whereas*, The experience of the past year has demonstrated more fully

than ever before the utility and importance of the canvassing work ; therefore—

Resolved, That we recommend to all our conferences to use all legitimate means to keep the ranks of the canvassers well filled with earnest and energetic laborers.

The necessity of not only having such a work as is provided for in the fifth resolution, but of issuing a 32-page tract, embodying the main features of the large work, in abridged form, was discussed with enthusiasm and interest at some length, when it was finally—

Voted, That a tract of suitable size be published, containing the most pointed arguments on the perpetuity of spiritual gifts, and some of the clearest evidences of personal experience, referring to the larger work for more complete evidence.

Voted, That the matter of the preparation of the books to be issued on the subject of spiritual gifts, be referred to the General Conference Committee, they to secure such assistance as they may deem best.

The Chair mentioned that Eld. R. S. Owen had requested an opportunity to lay before the Conference certain views on the subject of the seven trumpets, in order to get their counsel and advice on the subject. After remarks by several, it was—

Voted, That the Chair appoint a committee of ten to consider the views in question. The Chair named U. Smith, I. D. Van Horn, W. H. Littlejohn, J. N. Loughborough, E. W. Farnsworth, T. M. Steward, Wm. Covert, J. O. Corliss, H. A. St. John, and C. A. Washburn.

The Chair introduced the question of the propriety of transferring laborers from one field to another for the general good of the cause ; but pending discussion of how the changes could best be arranged and effected, the meeting adjourned to call of Chair.

SIXTH MEETING, NOV. 12, AT 10 A. M.—Prayer by Eld. O. A. Olsen. The matter of transferring laborers to other fields, which was under discussion when the last meeting adjourned, was the subject of extended remarks from Sr. White at this time. It was shown that such changes would benefit both the ministers and people, and that disaster to the cause would be averted if this plan were followed out.

Following these remarks, Eld. E. R. Jones made a statement of the standing of the Colorado Conference, urging upon the brethren the need of having another English and one Scandinavian laborer sent to that field.

Eld. J. O. Corliss then made an earnest plea that ministerial help should be sent to West Virginia and North Carolina, asking that the wants of these two States and of Florida, Maryland, and the city of Washington, be taken into consideration by the committee on destitute fields. It was then—

Voted, That the matter of making changes in laborers be referred to the committee on destitute fields, they to consult with the presidents of the different conferences and others concerned.

A communication from Eld. B. L. Whitney of Switzerland was read, giving the present standard of the Swiss Conference and the publishing work in Bâle, the progress during the past year, and the immediate wants of the mission. A set of resolutions passed at the recent meeting of the Swiss Conference was also read.

The meeting then adjourned to call of Chair.

SEVENTH MEETING, NOV. 12, AT 3 P. M.—A communication from Eld. A. C. Bourdeau was read, presenting the wants of the Canada Conference; also one from J. G. Matteson, setting forth the needs of the work in Northern Europe.

The Committee appointed to consider the matter of the Church Manual, made in substance the following report:—

It is the unanimous judgment of the committee, that it would not be advisable to have a Church Manual. We consider it unnecessary, because we have already surmounted the greatest difficulties connected with church organization without one, and perfect harmony exists among us on this subject. It would seem to many like a step toward the formation of a creed, or a discipline, other than the Bible,—something we have always been opposed to as a denomination. If we had one, we fear many, especially those commencing to preach, would study it to obtain guidance in religious matters, rather than to seek for it in the Bible, and from the leadings of the Spirit of God, which would tend to their hindrance in genuine religious experience and in knowledge of the mind of the Spirit. It was in taking similar steps that other bodies of Christians first began to lose their simplicity and become formal and spiritually lifeless. Why should we imitate them? The committee feel, in short, that our tendency should be in the direction of simplicity and close conformity to the Bible, rather than in elaborately defining every point in church management and church ordinances.

On motion, this report with reference to the Church Manual was accepted. It was then also—

Voted, That the President of the General Conference be requested to write an article for the *Review*, explaining the action of the Conference on the subject of the Manual.

The Committee on Resolutions then presented another partial report, the following resolutions being adopted after a very earnest and enthusiastic discussion:—

7. *Whereas*, The progress of the cause indicates that our leading denominational books will soon be needed in the languages of the countries where we have successful missions; therefore—

Resolved, That we prepare for the more rapid advancement of the message in the various nations by having these works immediately translated, that they may be published as soon as called for.

8. *Whereas*, The book lately published in the Danish-Norwegian language, containing a sketch of the life of Sr. White, and various extracts from her writings, is being received among the Scandinavian people, and is meeting a want long felt; and—

Whereas, That people call for other of Sr. White's writings in their language; therefore—

Resolved, That we recommend that the request above referred to be granted, and that immediate steps be taken to publish Sr. White's "Life of Christ" in the Danish-Norwegian language.

9. *Resolved*, That we recommend that such works of Sr. White's as are alluded to in the foregoing resolution, be published also in the French, German, and Swedish languages.

10. *Resolved*, That we recommend that the work, "Thoughts on Daniel and the Revelation," be issued in the German, Danish, and Swedish languages.

Following this, it was moved and seconded that the following be adopted:—

11. *Resolved*, That article 2 of the Constitution be amended by substituting the word "five" for the word "three," making the Executive Committee a committee of five, instead of three, as at present.

After considerable discussion and consideration, it was moved to amend the resolution by substituting "seven" instead of "five;" but on being put to vote, the amendment was lost. The question then recurring on the original motion, the amendment to the constitution was adopted by a unanimous vote.

The meeting then adjourned to call of Chair.

EIGHTH MEETING, Nov. 13, AT 3 P. M.—Prayer was offered by M. B. Miller. Pennsylvania being entitled to three delegates to the Conference, and only two being present, it was—

Voted, That J. E. Robinson be received as the third delegate from that Conference.

The Committee on Resolutions then presented the following recommendation:—

12. *Whereas*, The present situation in our foreign missions is such as to demand the presence and counsel of the President of the General Conference, and other help; therefore—

Resolved, That we recommend that Eld. Geo. I. Butler, as soon as consistent with other duties, visit the missions in England, Norway, and on the continent of Europe.

13. *Whereas*, It has already been decided to translate various works on the present truth into the Danish-Norwegian language, and such translations can evidently best be made in Europe, where the help of the best scholars and criticisms of Eld. J. G. Matteson can be obtained; therefore—

Resolved, That we recommend that A. B. Oyen go at his earliest convenience to Europe to engage in this work.

After a lengthy discussion, the above resolutions were adopted. The following resolution was then presented :—

14. *Whereas*, It is evident that it will soon be necessary to take advance steps in the way of establishing publishing interests in Europe ; and—

Whereas, Bro. W. C. White has had experience in this branch of the work ; therefore—

Resolved, That we recommend that the said W. C. White so arrange his business, the coming year, as to be at liberty to render the requisite assistance another season.

On motion, the above was referred to the General Conference Committee.

Eld. S. N. Haskell then introduced the question of having proper reports of our general meetings prepared and inserted in prominent papers. This had been done one season, several years ago, with good success, and it would be well if a similar movement could be made again, and continued. After remarks upon this subject from several, the following resolution was presented and adopted :—

15. *Resolved*, That it is the sense of this body that faithful reports of all our general gatherings should be made for the leading papers, and that the services of good reporters, selected from our people, should be secured for this purpose at the commencement of the meetings.

A communication from Eld. J. H. Waggoner was then read, reporting the progress made in revising and publishing certain tracts and books, and referring to other matters of interest to the Conference.

Adjourned to call of Chair.

NINTH MEETING, NOV. 14, AT 3 P. M.—Wm. Hill was chosen to fill a vacancy in the Indiana delegation, and E. S. Griggs to fill one in the Michigan list of delegates.

The following resolution was then presented and adopted :—

16. *Resolved*, That the Chair be authorized to appoint a committee of five to take into consideration our present system of church and district quarterly meetings, to suggest such changes as they may think best, and report at their earliest convenience, so that action may be taken at this session of the Conference.

J. H. Cook, D. T. Jones, John Fulton, H. M. Kenyon, and E. H. Gates were named.

Following a discussion as to the advantage to be gained by obtaining a secretary for the General Conference who could devote all his time to the work, a resolution was introduced as follows :—

17. *Whereas*, More thorough work can be accomplished in the various branches of our cause by faithful correspondence on the part of secretaries ; therefore—

Resolved, That the secretary of the General Conference be a person who can devote his entire time to the work of secretaryship.

Pending action on the above, the following substitute was presented :—

18. *Resolved*, That ART. H., SEC. 1, of the constitution be amended so as to read : The officers of this Conference shall be a President, a Recording Secretary, a Corresponding Secretary, a Treasurer, and an Executive Committee of five, of whom the President shall be one.

A discussion ensued, resulting in the adoption of the substitute, after which the amendment was passed by a unanimous vote.

A resolution was also introduced, recommending that the International T. and M. Society and the General Sabbath-School Association elect such secretaries as can devote their time to the work, but the propriety of acting upon this matter in the General Conference was questioned. The subject was finally referred to the Committee on Resolutions.

Meeting adjourned to call of Chair.

TENTH MEETING, FRIDAY, NOV. 16, AT 10 A. M.—The Committee on Resolutions presented the following for the consideration of the Conference :—

19. *Whereas*, Eld. J. N. Loughborough has been called from the English mission to labor in this country; therefore—

Resolved, That the General Conference Committee engage two suitable persons, as soon as they can decide upon the proper individuals, to enter upon the work in that mission.

20. *Resolved*, That it is our judgment, considering all the circumstances, that the time has not yet come for the erection of a building for the use of the mission in Bâle, Suisse.

21. *Resolved*, That it is our judgment that Eld. B. L. Whitney, for the present, take editorial charge of *Les Signes des Temps* and all other papers that may be published at Bâle, employing such assistance as may seem to him to be necessary.

22. *Resolved*, That the General Conference Committee, as soon as practicable, select a suitable person to go to the help of Eld. J. G. Matteson in Christiania, Norway.

23. *Resolved*, That we are heartily in favor of opening reading-rooms in the leading cities of this country, as soon as proper persons can be found to engage in such enterprises.

24. *Resolved*, That it is our judgment that Eld. J. P. Rosqvist labor for some months to come with Eld. O. A. Olsen, the work of the former being especially to advance the cause among the Swedes of this country.

25. *Resolved*, That we express ourselves as highly gratified with the exercises in Bible-readings, conducted by Bro. Haskell and others at this Conference, and we recommend that such exercises be encouraged in all parts of the country; and the better to secure this end, we recommend the formation of a Bible-reading Bureau to take the oversight of the work, to be organized after the following plan : 1. There shall be a central committee of five who shall have charge of the work of publishing and distributing printed lessons to the members of the organization. 2. The conditions of the membership shall be the payment of one dollar a year and the furnishing of one or more original readings a month, to the committee. Those complying with these conditions shall receive from the committee

a printed sheet monthly, containing one or more lessons for each week. 3. Those who do not choose to become members on the foregoing conditions, may secure the printed lessons by becoming subscribers at \$5 a year.

A full discussion of these recommendations ensued, after which they were adopted as the sense of the body.

The Committee on Credentials and Licenses then presented the following partial report: For credentials: J. G. Matteson, A. A. John, B. L. Whitney, Geo. I. Butler, S. N. Haskell, J. Fargo; Wm. F. Killen, of Georgia; L. P. Hodges and S. H. Kime, of North Carolina; for ship-missionary's license, Geo. R. Drew, of England; for license, Wm. M. Baird, of North Carolina; A. A. Meredith and Wm. Foggin, of West Virginia; J. R. Waite, of Alabama.

Each name of the above was considered, and the recommendations of the Committee adopted.

On motion, the Chair was empowered to appoint the central committee of the Bible-reading Bureau. This committee was afterward announced as follows: U. Smith, W. C. Sisley, W. H. Littlejohn, E. B. Miller, M. J. Chapman. It was also—

Voted, That the Chair appoint a committee of three to consider the matter of ministers' quarterly and annual reports. H. A. St. John, J. D. Rice, and R. M. Kilgore were named as this committee.

Meeting adjourned to call of Chair.

ELEVENTH MEETING, 2:20 P. M.—The report of the financial standing of the General Conference was presented at this meeting, and accepted. This report is as follows:—

TREASURER'S REPORT.

M. J. Chapman in account with the General Conference of S. D. Adventists:—

	Dr.	
To cash on hand, Nov. 1, 1882,	\$8,038 42	
“ “ rec'd to Oct. 31, 1883,	5,871 91	
Total,		\$13,910 33
	Cr.	
By cash paid out from Nov. 1, 1882, to Oct. 31, 1883,	\$6,823 49	
Balance in Treasury, Oct. 31, 1883,	7,086 84	
Total,		\$13,910 33

The committee appointed to consider the wants of destitute fields, then made the following recommendations:—

- a. That Eld. Wm. Ostrander, of Michigan, go to Colorado to assist Eld. E. R. Jones in that field of labor.
- b. That Eld. J. N. Loughborough hold general meetings in New York, Pennsylvania, and Michigan during the winter and early spring, and then by April 1 proceed to California to assist in general work there.
- c. That there be an interchange of laborers and a blending of in-

terests between the New England and the Vermont Conferences.

d. That Eld. J. O. Corliss be allowed to select his own field of labor.

e. That Eld. S. H. Lane take an oversight of the work in Virginia, and labor some time there; that Bro. H. A. Rife labor with Bro. Lane, and afterward with some experienced minister in Indiana.

f. That Eld. R. S. Owen labor with Eld. A. C. Bourdeau in the Canada Conference.

g. That Eld. R. Conradi, after having labored in Dakota and Kansas during the winter and spring, go to Pennsylvania to engage in tent labor the coming season among the Germans.

h. That the fields of Florida, Arkansas, and Alabama be referred to the General Conference Committee.

On motion, these recommendations were considered separately; feeling remarks were made in reference to the changes thus to be effected, showing a disposition to submit to the will of God and the judgment of the brethren in regard to these matters. The report of the committee was then, by vote, adopted.

Following this, the committee on credentials and licenses presented the name of D. T. Bourdeau for credentials. On motion, this recommendation was adopted.

The meeting then adjourned to call of Chair.

TWELFTH AND THIRTEENTH MEETINGS, Nov. 19.—It was voted that J. N. Loughborough receive credentials from the Conference for the coming year.

The report of the Nominating Committee was then presented as follows: For President, Geo. I. Butler; Secretary, U. Smith; Corresponding Secretary, Mrs. F. H. Sisley; Treasurer, A. R. Henry; Executive Committee, Geo. I. Butler, S. N. Haskell, W. C. White, J. Fargo, O. A. Olsen.

These names were acted upon separately, and the persons nominated were declared elected.

The Committee of ten appointed to consider the subject of the seven trumpets, then reported as follows:—

“Your committee appointed to consider a new exposition of the prophecy of the seven trumpets of Rev. 8 and 9, would respectfully report that they see no occasion to change from the views we have formerly entertained, especially as the proposed view is, in their judgment, unscriptural, and would unsettle some of the most important and fundamental points of our faith.”

On motion, the above was adopted as the sense of the Conference.

The committee to whom was referred the matter of suggesting a

better plan for church and district quarterly meetings, submitted the following report:—

"The committee to whom were referred the subjects of quarterly and district meetings, having had the same under consideration, beg leave to submit the following for your consideration: Instead of holding the quarterly meeting the first Sabbath in the quarter, and the district quarterly meeting the Sabbath following, we recommend that they be so arranged in each district that they will follow each other in coasecutive order, each one coming one week later, until each district has had its quarterly and district meeting; and we would further recommend that at the beginning of each Conference year, each State Conference committee proceed to arrange for carrying out this system, so that a complete round of these meetings can be held in each district in the State once in three months."

These recommendations were considered at some length, but as the plan presented was not considered a feasible one, the motion to adopt, on being put to vote, was lost.

The following recommendations from the Committee on Resolutions were then considered:—

26. *Whereas*, We, as students of prophecy, have for years anticipated the present Sunday movement, and understand that there is a conflict before us, the magnitude of which can scarcely be appreciated; and—

Whereas, Thousands of earnest Christians are laboring sincerely for the enforcement of the Sunday law, who would not do so if the claims of the true Sabbath were placed before them; therefore—

Resolved, That we remind our people of their duty to place the great light which God has given them upon the Sabbath question before others; and we urge that this be done before the leaders of this Sunday movement have opportunity to represent the issues of this question in a false light.

27. *Resolved*, That we need tracts, both large and small, upon the present issues of the Sunday movement.

28. *Whereas*, The ever-shifting front of this Sunday question calls constantly for new arguments, and the stealth of their movements calls for constant vigilance; therefore—

Resolved, That we recommend the publication of a four-page paper, the size of the *Review*, monthly, whose mission shall be to oppose this Sunday law enforcement, this paper to be conducted by a committee of five, appointed by this Conference.

29. *Resolved*, That in our judgment it would be well for Eld. Haskell to accompany Eld. Butler on his visit to the European missions, and we recommend him to do so if consistent with other duties.

30. *Whereas*, There are important mission fields in the islands of the Pacific Ocean which should be entered as soon as practicable; therefore—

Resolved, That we invite men of means, who have experience in the truth, acting under the advice of their Conference committee, to visit or locate in these fields, that they may become acquainted with the customs of the people, learn the wants of the field, encourage and maintain colporter work, and thus prepare the way for the more direct efforts of the missionary.

These resolutions called forth stirring remarks in their favor from many of the delegates present, showing a lively interest in the actions recommended. Each resolution was considered separately, and by vote adopted.

The Committee on Credentials and Licenses recommended that Mrs. E. G. White, J. P. Rosqvist, and O. A. Olsen receive credentials from the Conference; and that W. C. White be ordained and receive credentials. On motion, this report was adopted.

Adjourned to call of Chair.

FOURTEENTH AND FIFTEENTH MEETINGS, Nov. 20.—The condition and wants of the cause among the Germans was the first subject introduced. Eld. R. Conradi gave a very interesting account of the rise and progress of the work of present truth among this nationality, the nature of the work especially among the Mennonites, and the crying need of laborers in this tongue. Remarks were also made in the same direction by Brn. H. A. Rife, A. Snyder, O. A. Olsen, S. N. Haskell, and S. H. Lane, after which the following resolution was introduced and adopted :—

31. *Resolved*, That we recommend Bro. H. A. Rife, and all our preachers who are able to labor in the German tongue, to devote their efforts to the interests of our cause among the German people; and we recommend that all who can speak the German language labor to spread the truth among that people in any and all the ways provided for by our different organizations.

The Committee on Resolutions then presented the following :—

32. *Whereas*, Some of the bound volumes of the "Testimonies to the Church" are out of print, so that full sets cannot be obtained at the Office; and—

Whereas, There is a constant and urgent call for the reprinting of these volumes; therefore—

Resolved, That we recommend their republication in such a form as to make four volumes of seven or eight hundred pages each.

33. *Whereas*, Many of these testimonies were written under the most unfavorable circumstances, the writer being too heavily pressed with anxiety and labor to devote critical thought to the grammatical perfection of the writings, and they were printed in such haste as to allow these imperfections to pass uncorrected; and—

Whereas, We believe the light given by God to his servants is by the enlightenment of the mind, thus imparting the thoughts, and not (except in rare cases) the very words in which the ideas should be expressed; therefore—

Resolved, That in the republication of these volumes such verbal changes be made as to remove the above-named imperfections, as far as possible, without in any measure changing the thought; and, further—

34. *Resolved*, That this body appoint a committee of five to take charge of the republication of these volumes according to the above preambles and resolutions.

35. *Resolved*, That we hereby express our thanks to the various railroads, especially the Michigan Central and Grand Trunk, for favors extended to the delegates to this meeting; and also to the papers of this city for the publication of reports.

36. *Resolved*, That we hereby express our appreciation of the kindness of the Battle Creek Church in entertaining those from abroad during the progress of the Bible-reading Institute and the General Conference.

The above were considered separately, and adopted.

The committee of five to take charge of the republication of the testimonies provided for in the thirty-fourth resolution was announced as follows, the Chair having been empowered to select four persons besides himself for this purpose: W. C. White, Uriah Smith, J. H. Waggoner, S. N. Haskell, Geo. I. Butler.

On motion, the General Conference Committee was empowered to appoint the committee of five, who, according to the twenty-eighth resolution, are to conduct the paper to be issued on the subject of the Sunday law movement.

The committee on destitute fields then made its final report. It is recommended—

i. That Eld. J. H. Cook, of Kansas, and Eld. A. J. Cudney, of Nebraska, interchange labor as far as practicable.

j. That Eld. A. O. Burrill, of Michigan, go to Vermont as soon as possible, and consider that State his field of labor.

k. That Eld. G. G. Rupert, of Ohio, go to Kentucky, and labor in connection with Eld. Osborn.

l. That Eld. J. P. Henderson, of Indiana, go to Ohio, to fill Eld. Rupert's place.

m. That Eld. H. A. St. John, of Ohio, on account of his health, go to California, to labor in the churches of Oakland and San Francisco, and such other places as those concerned may direct.

n. That other destitute fields be referred to the General Conference Committee.

Each item of the above was considered separately. The matter of sending Eld. J. P. Henderson to Ohio, was, by vote, referred to the General Conference Committee, with instructions to send some other laborer from Indiana to Ohio, provided the Committee does not see fit to send Bro. Henderson. With the exception of the above, the several items of the report were adopted.

The subject of organizing a city mission in Chicago was introduced, and interesting remarks relative to this were made. The brethren in Illinois have about \$3,000 ready to start this work, and probably more could be raised if the work were commenced.

On motion, the matter was referred to the General Conference Committee with instructions to take it into consideration before the committee should separate. The committee appointed to introduce a plan for ministers' quarterly and annual reports, made a verbal report; but as the time was too short to have the plan considered by the body, the matter was referred to the General Conference Committee for consideration.

The Committee on Credentials and Licenses recommended that credentials be granted to M. C. Wilcox, and that A. B. Oyen be or-

dained, and receive credentials. On motion, these recommendations were adopted. It was also—

Voted, That this Conference request that Sr. White's talks at the early morning meetings, and such other matter as may be considered advisable, be published.

Following remarks by Sr. White, the ordination service was held, Eld. Geo. I. Butler offering the prayer, and Eld. S. N. Haskell delivering the charge.

Adjourned *sine die*.

GEO. I. BUTLER, *Pres.*

A. B. OYEN, *Sec.*

INTERNATIONAL TRACT AND MISSIONARY SOCIETY PROCEEDINGS.

EIGHTH ANNUAL SESSION.

THE first meeting of the eighth annual session of the International Tract and Missionary Society was held Sunday morning, Nov. 11, at 9 A. M. Prayer by Eld. E. W. Farnsworth. On motion, the reading of the minutes of the last meeting was waived. The State societies were represented by one hundred and nine delegates, as follows: Michigan, thirty; Iowa, sixteen; Wisconsin, five; California, two; Minnesota, three; New York, two; Illinois, three; New England, seven; Ohio, four; Kansas, two; Pennsylvania, three; Vermont, four; Maine, two; Indiana, six; Missouri, three; Texas, two; Dakota, three; Virginia, two; Colorado, one; Nebraska, four; Tennessee, one; England, one.

Remarks were then made by the President, in which he stated the object of the Society, and briefly reviewed the labor of the past year. He also set forth to some extent the work to be accomplished the coming year. Publications to the value of over \$3,500, at much less than wholesale prices, consisting of bound books for libraries, "Life of Christ" (Library), in pamphlet form, other pamphlets and tracts, clubs of the *Signs*, and old periodicals, have been distributed since the last annual meeting by this Society to different parts of this country and to other countries, including the following places: Boston, New Bedford, Providence, New York, Chicago, life-saving stations along the coast, different points in the South, Canada, Dakota, Oregon, N. A.; Hayti, Tobago, Trinidad, W. I.; British Guiana, S. A.; Hull, Bristol, Liverpool, and London, Eng.; Norway, Denmark, Sweden, and Germany.

This work has largely been accomplished by persons to whom publications have been sent in quantities. In addition to the avenues already opened for sending reading matter free of cost, the demand for it at several points in the West Indies, South America, Nova

Scotia, and other places, is such as to require a free transportation to these countries. With the exception of bound books presented to libraries, about one-half of this reading matter has been sent from So. Lancaster, Mass., about one hundred dollars' worth has been sent from Oakland, Cal., and the balance from Battle Creek, Mich.

The committee appointed two years ago to prepare a small certificate of membership for the Society, reported that they had been unable to obtain a satisfactory design, at the same time exhibiting a design for criticism.

The Chair, having been empowered, named the following committees: To criticise and make suggestions on certificates, S. H. Lane, U. Smith, W. C. Sisley; on Nominations, A. S. Hutchins, R. M. Kilgore, W. C. Sisley; on Resolutions, W. C. White, E. W. Farnsworth, J. O. Corliss.

SECOND MEETING, NOV. 13, AT 10 A. M.—The Chair stated the following points for consideration:—

1. Certain defects in the Constitution. 2. Shall the Society use new periodicals for distribution in the place of old ones? 3. What relation does this Society sustain to such missions as the Chicago and New York City missions?

On motion, the Chair was empowered to appoint a committee of three or five to examine the Constitution, and so revise it that it shall provide for the necessities of the Society in its growing condition. A letter was read from Boise City, Idaho, containing an earnest appeal for labor, as illustrating the many existing openings where clubs of the *Signs* could be used to advantage. This letter called forth interesting remarks from Bro. White, Cudney, Loughborough, and Sisley.

Moved by Bro. W. C. White, that the International Society have the privilege of using from five hundred to one thousand copies of the *Signs*, as the Executive Board may see fit. Moved to amend this motion so as to read, from one thousand to five thousand copies. While the question was discussed, it was moved by Eld. Butler to substitute for the motion, an invitation to the Executive Board to make use of all the publications which it can use judiciously. This motion was unanimously carried.

Eld. Loughborough spoke in behalf of the mission at Liverpool, and Bro. Wm. J. Boynton, of the New York City Mission, both urging the need of more publications. The wants of the Chicago Mission were also spoken of, as well as the necessity of systematic missionary labor in other cities. Eld. S. H. Lane spoke in behalf of Indianapolis, and Eld. J. O. Corliss of Washington, D. C. In view of the great demand now existing for reading matter, it was suggested that our brethren should carefully preserve their papers, and when they do not longer need them for reference, that they

should donate them to the missionary work. A portfolio was exhibited and recommended for the purpose of receiving periodicals as they come from the publishing house week by week.

Moved and carried, that the Chair appoint a committee to arrange plans for gathering up these periodicals and regulating the supply at different points.

A question was then raised on the advisability of using tract distributors in depots, which called out remarks from Brn. Butler, Boynton, White, Whitney, Oviatt, and others. Various plans for getting the truth before the public were also discussed at some length.

On motion, the Chair was authorized to appoint a committee to consider the matter of tract distributors. Elds. D. B. Oviatt, R. A. Underwood, and H. Nicola were named as said committee. Two other committees were also appointed as follows: W. C. Sisley, D. A. Robinson, E. W. Whitney, S. H. Lane, and M. L. Huntley on revising Constitution; A. J. Cudney, Wm. J. Boynton, W. C. White, H. W. Decker, and M. H. Brown to devise systematic plans for gathering up old periodicals.

THIRD MEETING, WEDNESDAY, AT 7 P. M.—Prayer by Eld. Van Horn. The Committee on small certificate reported that while the committee had no special objection to the design presented, it was their opinion that could the large certificates be brought down to about the size of the small design, it would be, with a few alterations, superior to the present form. After some remarks, this report was accepted. The Committee on revising the Constitution also reported. (See revised Constitution.)

The Committee on Resolutions reported as follows:—

1. *Whereas*, The holding of Bible-readings in families and with individuals, accompanied with other colporteur work, is one of the most effectual ways of interesting people in the present truth; and—

Whereas, The distribution of the *Signs* has been found to be the best introduction to the Bible-readings; therefore—

Resolved, That we recommend to our colporters the following plan: First, Let the fields be thoroughly canvassed for trial subscriptions for the *Signs of the Times*; Secondly, Visit all subscribers once in two weeks, or oftener, to arouse the interest of those who have not read their papers, and to answer the queries of those who begin to be interested, by reading or persuading them to read such Scripture texts as will answer their inquiries; Thirdly, Continue the work by frequent Bible-readings, the judicious circulation of tracts, the sale of larger works, and by other missionary work as the way may open.

2. *Whereas*, Four weeks is too short a time to fully interest readers in the *Signs*; therefore—

Resolved, That we recommend trial subscriptions to be taken for six weeks at twenty-five cents.

3. *Whereas*, There are many persons who, in connection with other business,

can secure short term subscriptions for the *Signs*, but who are unable to re-visit and carry forward the work ; therefore—

Resolved, That we recommend such to do all they can, placing their list in the hands of the State Secretary, or some vigilant missionary society, who will send the papers, and follow up the work by correspondence.

4. *Whereas*, The Conferences in which most of our city missions are located, are unable to fully meet the expenses of those missions ; therefore—

Resolved, That this Society furnish them with periodicals and books as the Executive Committee may think best.

5. *Whereas*, It is very important that our leading books be widely circulated, and the public libraries present one of the best avenues of circulation ; therefore—

Resolved, That we recommend "Sketches from the Life of Paul," "The United States in Prophecy," and "The Sanctuary," to be placed in those libraries having the ten volumes ; and that all these volumes, in their best binding, be placed in the best libraries of our large cities which have not the ten books ; and that this Society furnish these volumes to the State societies, for this purpose, at one-fourth the retail price.

6. *Whereas*, The city of Washington, D. C., is an important missionary field, and should be entered by some of our workers ; and—

Whereas, Bro. Reuben Wright is quite thoroughly acquainted with that field, and is one whose circumstances would permit him to devote time and means to the work ; therefore—

Resolved, That we invite him to immediately engage in the work of introducing the printed truth in that vicinity, doing colporter work, or aiding others to do the same, and that he have the oversight of that field.

Resolved, That this Society furnish for that field periodicals and books as the Executive Committee may deem advisable.

7. *Whereas*, God has given us great light on the subject of temperance ; and—

Whereas, Our health journal (*Good Health*) occupies a position in the temperance field that no other journal does ; therefore—

Resolved, That we earnestly recommend our State societies to labor diligently to secure the subscriptions of all Sabbath-keeping families in their territory.

8. *Whereas*, Some of our successful canvassers for "Thoughts on Daniel and the Revelation" have secured many subscribers for *Good Health* without detriment to their other work ; therefore—

Resolved, That we recommend our experienced canvassers for "Thoughts on Daniel and the Revelation" to work for *Good Health* at the same time.

9. *Whereas*, We believe the steel engraving, "Christ the Way of Life," teaches an important lesson, and may be successfully used in the missionary field as an introduction to our other religious works ; therefore—

Resolved, That we recommend it to our agents and colporters as a valuable auxiliary to the financial success of their work.

10. *Whereas*, Experience in canvassing and colporter work is more valuable than oral or written instruction ; therefore—

Resolved, That, as far as possible, beginners should be sent out in company with experienced workers ; and where this is not practicable, we recommend them to labor in companies of two or three, in order that they may frequently meet to compare experiences, and counsel with each other for mutual encouragement.

These resolutions were considered separately, and adopted.

FOURTH MEETING, NOV. 18, AT 9 A. M.—The committee on tract distributors recommended that the matter of their use be left to the discretion of those having charge of the missionary work in the State or mission. From experiences related, it was evident that while the distributor would do a good work in some places, in others, reading matter, if placed there would immediately be destroyed. It was recommended that persons having charge of such means for distributing reading matter should exercise great care in its use.

The committee on collecting old periodicals made the following report :—

"Your committee appointed to devise means for gathering periodicals which are donated to the missions from the different States, and forwarding the same, would recommend that all periodicals of this kind be delivered to the State Secretaries, and when a sufficient amount for shipment (not less than one hundred pounds), has accumulated, the State Secretaries shall report the same to the Secretary of the International Society, and await said Secretary's order when and where to ship them. To save confusion, we further recommend that all orders from the different missions for papers shall be addressed to the Secretary of the International Society. We also recommend that each State Society pre-pay freight on shipments to the different missions.

This report was adopted.

The matter of using printed letters was then introduced, and after a free discussion, the following resolution was adopted :—

Resolved, That a printed letter is contrary to the spirit of our missionary work, and should be discouraged among our workers throughout the field.

Several present who had used these letters testified to the unsatisfactory results of the same.

Resolved, That we recommend that the *Signs of the Times* be sent to all those libraries which have received our books, and that this Society assist our poor State Societies by furnishing the *Signs* to them for this purpose at one dollar a year.

This resolution was adopted, also a resolution explanatory of Art. V. in the Constitution. (See Constitution.)

The financial report was read as follows :—

Cash on hand last year,	\$2,068 07
Received during the year,	2,830 25
Total,	\$4,998 32
Paid for bound books for libraries,	\$2,031 53
" " other publications,	1,012 98
" " " periodicals,	335 87
<i>Signs</i> , portfolios, printing, freight, etc.,	325 28
Cash on hand,	1,243 16
Total,	\$4,998 32

The Committee on Nominations presented the following report, which was adopted as a whole :—

President, Eld. S. N. Haskell ; Vice-President, W. C. White ; Secretary and Treasurer, M. L. Huntley ; Assistant Secretaries, Nellie Sisley Starr, Jennie Thayer, Barbara Rice ; Executive Committee, S. N. Haskell, Geo. I. Butler, O. A. Olsen, M. H. Brown, W. C. Sisley.

FIFTH MEETING, NOV. 20, AT 3:30 P. M.—Moved by W. C. White that the Society recommend the use of the same premiums with periodicals and the same terms as last year.

A printed table showing the labor performed by the State societies and other items of interest was distributed, which showed the following increase over the labor performed last year :—

No. of reports returned,	2,538
" " members added,	398
" " missionary visits,	32,437
" " letters written,	5,919
" " yearly subscriptions obtained,	1,563
" " pages of tracts distributed,	3,642,588
" " periodicals,	125,768

On motion, it was voted to recommend the several State societies to raise a sufficient reserve fund to meet the expenses of issuing a paper in connection with the Sunday agitation at such times as it may be done to advantage. The intent of this resolution was not that the reserve fund should be consumed by any enterprise of this kind, but simply that it be held in readiness to be used in case of an emergency, and afterward replenished in some way.

Valuable suggestions were then made by W. C. White respecting the sale of books by tract societies. He recommended the use of advertising circulars gotten out by the Offices, bearing the address of the society as agent, affixed by means of rubber stamps. "Sunshine at Home," "The Home Circle," and "Sunshine Series" were recommended with other books as just the ones to be introduced before the holidays. "The Coming Conflict" was also spoken of as a book which should be at once circulated among the people.

Meeting adjourned *sine die*.

M. L. HUNTLEY, Sec.

S. N. HASKELL, Pres.

S. D. A. PUBLISHING ASSOCIATION PROCEEDINGS.

TWENTY-SECOND ANNUAL SESSION.

THE stockholders of the S. D. A. Publishing Association met for their twenty-fourth annual session, at Battle Creek, Mich., according to appointment, Nov. 15, at 2 P. M. U. Smith opened the meeting by prayer. The names of the stockholders present being taken, it was ascertained that there were 193 present, representing 372 shares

in person, and 596 by proxy. The reading of the minutes of the last meeting was waived.

As the first business, the Treasurer presented his report as follows :—

TREASURER'S REPORT.

A. R. Henry in account with the S. D. A. Publishing Association :—

To cash on hand Nov. 1, 1882,

Dr.
\$15,696 65

RECEIPTS.

To cash received on Mich. Conf. Fund,	\$16,767 16
“ “ “ “ Gen. “ “	5,871 91
“ “ “ “ accounts,	253,190 86
“ “ “ “ sales,	50,902 19
“ “ “ “ job work,	34,957 01
“ “ “ “ bills receivable,	17,204 70
“ “ “ “ stock notes (conditional),	2,382 80
“ “ “ “ bills payable and deposits,	78,483 78
“ “ “ “ Review,	12,354 28
“ “ “ “ Instructor,	6,129 35
“ “ “ “ Tidende,	1,506 13
“ “ “ “ Harold,	545 54
“ “ “ “ Skanne,	626 47
“ “ “ “ shares,	6,082 50
“ “ “ “ donations and legacies,	1,136 78
“ “ “ “ rent,	508 02
“ “ “ “ fuel,	719 47
“ “ “ “ type,	30 42
“ “ “ “ machinery,	553 50
“ “ “ “ interest,	2,046 33
“ “ “ “ building and repairs,	11 90
“ “ “ “ labor,	41 75
“ “ “ “ incidentals,	157 80
“ “ “ “ stock,	917 19
“ “ “ “ discount,	348 75
“ “ “ “ Instructor cuts,	5 98
“ “ “ “ Office fixtures,	6 55
Total,	\$399,731 73

DISBURSEMENTS.

By am't paid to Mich. Conf. Fund,	\$15,154 53
“ “ “ “ Gen. “ “	6,823 49
“ “ “ “ accounts,	255,920 30
“ “ “ “ bills receivable,	26,511 81
“ “ “ “ bills payable and deposits,	89,486 78
“ “ “ “ stock,	39,487 59
“ “ “ “ labor,	37,562 50
“ “ “ “ incidentals,	9,796 63
“ “ “ “ Office fixtures,	1,108 84
“ “ “ “ manuscript and royalties,	8,309 28
“ “ “ “ real estate,	5,078 41
“ “ “ “ machinery,	3,543 54
“ “ “ “ fuel,	4,896 09
“ “ “ “ type,	1,018 40
“ “ “ “ interest,	4,705 82
“ “ “ “ building and repairs,	305 83
“ “ “ “ job work,	46 20
“ “ “ “ Instructor cuts,	95 37
“ “ “ “ insurance,	474 05
“ “ “ “ discount,	21 51
Total expenditures,	\$305,138 92
Cash on hand to balance, Oct. 31, 1883,	4,594 81
Total,	\$309,731 73

STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL CONDITION OF THE S. D. A. P. ASSOCIATION.

Real estate,	\$46,428 41	Bills payable,	\$69,974 39
Personal property,	72,842 84	Certificates,	70,620 80
Bills receivable,	32,622 52	Capital stock,	38,080 00
Sanitarium Knitting Co.,	13,375 51	Donations,	12,925 55
Due from banks,	13,540 08	Surplus,	78,722 00
Cash on hand,	4,584 81	Personal acc'ts,	13,785 74
Material on hand,	26,778 07	General Conference,	7,086 84
Books, pamphlets, tracts, etc.,	34,282 18	Michigan Conference,	5,809 06
	\$244,454 37		\$244,454 37

RECAPITULATION.

Capital stock,	\$38,080 00
Donations,	12,925 55
Surplus,	78,722 00
Present worth,	\$129,677 55
Assets Nov. 1, 1882,	\$141,838 88
" " 1, 1883,	129,677 55
Decrease,*	\$12,161 33

Respectfully submitted,

A. R. HENRY, *Treas.*

This is to certify that I have examined the accounts of the S. D. A. Publishing Association, and find them correctly kept, and that the above report is a correct statement of its financial standing, according to my best knowledge and belief.

W. C. SISLEY, *Auditor.*

The Treasurer's and Auditor's reports were accepted.

The matter of appointing the usual committees having been by vote referred to the Chair, he made the following announcements:—

For Nominating Committee: S. H. Lane, I. D. Van Horn, R. M. Kilgore.

For Committee on Resolutions: W. C. White, U. Smith, H. A. St. John.

The meeting then adjourned to call of Chair.

SECOND MEETING, NOV. 19, AT 2:30 P. M.—Prayer by Eld. S. N. Haskell. Minutes of previous meeting read and approved.

The Nominating Committee reported, recommending that the following persons be chosen to the offices named: For President, Geo. I. Butler; Vice-President, H. W. Kellogg; Secretary, Mrs. M. J. Chapman; Treasurer, A. R. Henry; Auditor, W. C. Sisley; Publishing Committee, Geo. I. Butler, U. Smith, Geo. W. Amadon.

* *NOTE.*—It is justice to the foregoing report, a word of explanation should be given, showing why the present worth now appears less than it appeared last year. It comes simply from the fact that some portions of the property inventoried have been placed at a lower figure than that of last year, amounting, in the aggregate, to over twenty-three thousand dollars. Had the property been inventoried as in the report of 1882, there would have appeared a gain of over ten thousand dollars. But it has been thought best to make a change for two reasons: First, to avoid the possibility of carrying along any articles at a fictitious value; and, secondly, to place our book business on a more consistent basis. The greatest reduction has been made in this respect, and the change and the reasons for it may be briefly stated as follows: Heretofore the books when placed on the shelves for sale have been inventoried at wholesale prices. Under this arrangement a heavy sale of books would show no gain; and if reduced rates were given, it would appear as an actual loss. Now it has been thought best to rate the books on the shelves at manufacturer's cost, and let the profits appear on the sales. Hence a large part of the reduction shown in the accompanying report, will come back to the Office when the books are sold.

These persons were then formally nominated by ballot, and afterward, by vote, declared unanimously elected.

The Committee on Resolutions then reported the following:—

Whereas, The General Conference has recommended the publication of certain works in the foreign languages, and the translation of others, that they may be ready for publication as soon as called for ; therefore—

Resolved, That this Association shall carry out these recommendations, and we request the trustees to put these plans into immediate execution.

Whereas, Our State Tract Societies feel that it is a hardship to pay the same price for tracts as they receive from the districts, and thus lose the cost of transportation ; therefore—

Resolved, That we recommend the trustees to fix the discount on tracts to State Tract Societies at fifty-five per cent instead of fifty per cent as heretofore.

After a brief discussion, these resolutions were unanimously adopted.

The committee appointed at the last annual meeting of this Association to suggest at this meeting changes in our Constitution, reported, recommending that the following changes be made :—

1. Amend Section 14 of Article II. to read as follows : " It shall be the duty of the Treasurer to keep a Stock Certificate Book, a Transfer Book, and a Stock Ledger."

2. Add a new section to Article IV. to stand as Section 3, the same to read as follows : " All transfers of stock shall be made by written assignment on the Treasurer's Transfer Book, subscribed by the assignor, or his duly authorized attorney, accompanied by a surrender of the certificate granted for the stock."

3. Repeal Section 5 of Article IX., which reads: " The President and Secretary may vote according to the number of shares they hold respectively, or may be proxy for others, and in case of a tie the President may have a decisive vote."

4. Amend Section 8 of Article IX. to read as follows: " The form of proxy shall be as follows:—

"PROXY.

"Know all men by these presents: That I ———— owning ———— share . . . of capital stock in the Seventh-day Adventist Publishing Association of Battle Creek, Michigan, do hereby appoint ———— of ————, my attorney for me and in my stead, to vote for me as my proxy, upon all questions that may come before any meeting of the stockholders of said Association, according to the number of votes I should be entitled to cast if then personally present.

"This proxy shall be in force until it is revoked in writing.

"Witness my signature this ———— day of ———— 188—. ————."

5. Repeal Section 9 of Article IX., which reads: " When such writing shall have been acknowledged before some person authorized to take acknowledgment of deeds, and shall have attached to it his certificate stating that the person named in the writing executed the same, the member named in said writing who appears at the meeting of the Association, bearing said writing, shall be empowered to vote as proxy."

6. Amend the existing by-law on the subject of meetings of the Board of Trustees to read as follows : " Meetings of the Board may be held at any time on the written call of any two members thereof, by a personal notice to said trus-

tees; or by a written notice left at the residence of said trustees; but in case any trustee is a non-resident of the city of Battle Creek, it shall not be necessary to give any notice, written or personal, to such trustee; *provided always* that a majority of the Board are notified.

"Upon the delivery of the written call to the Secretary, it shall be his duty to notify the trustees of such meeting."

The next business being the election of editors for the *Review and Herald*, U. Smith was elected editor for the coming year, and J. H. Waggoner and Geo. I. Butler corresponding editors.

On motion that the Chair appoint a committee to issue a new edition of our Constitution and By-laws with all revisions to date, U. Smith, G. W. Amadon, and A. R. Henry were appointed as said committee.

Adjourned to call of Chair.
M. J. CHAPMAN, *Sec.*

GEO. I. BUTLER, *Pre*

PACIFIC SEVENTH-DAY ADVENTIST PUBLISHING ASSOCIATION.

EIGHTH ANNUAL MEETING.

IN accordance with notice, the eighth annual meeting of the shareholders of the above Association was held at the office of the Pacific Press on Monday, April 23, 1883.

After prayer, the President, Eld. S. N. Haskell, named W. A. Pratt, Wm. Butcher, and Eld. J. D. Rice, Committee on Nominations; and Eld. J. H. Waggoner, Eld. W. M. Healey, and E. A. Chapman, Committee on Resolutions. The meeting was then adjourned to the church, where on re-assembling it was found that 869 shares were represented by stockholders present, and 1,349 by proxy; in all 441 shares more than the number required to constitute a quorum.

The minutes of the last meeting having been read and approved, the Secretary submitted the revenue account and balance sheet for the year ending March 31, 1883. Eld. Haskell, Eld. Waggoner, C. H. Jones, and W. C. White spoke in regard to the working of the past year.

The Committee on Nominations submitted the following names to the meeting: S. N. Haskell, M. C. Israel, C. H. Jones, Wm. Saunders, and W. C. White. These persons, upon being duly balloted for, were elected as directors for the ensuing year. Eld. J. H. Waggoner was then elected editor, E. J. Waggoner, assistant editor, and Elds. J. N. Andrews and Uriah Smith, corresponding editors of the *Signs of the Times* for the next year. Eld. S. N.

Haskell, W. C. White, and Eld. J. H. Waggoner were elected to act as a Publishing Committee.

The meeting then adjourned till 2:30, and being convened at that hour, the Committee on Resolutions submitted the following, which were unanimously adopted:—

Resolved, (1.) That we renew the expression of our gratitude to Divine Providence for the prosperity of our cause in connection with the publishing work during the past year, and hereby renew our pledge to sustain the work by our means and our prayers.

(2.) That we recognize the necessity of possessing extensive publishing facilities; and the late issue over the Sunday law, wherein it was found necessary to defend our civil and religious rights, and to uphold the truth of the commandment of God, by publishing a special edition of the *Signs*, has fully proved that it was in the direct providence of God that the Office was established on its present basis.

(3.) That, in answer to inquiries on this subject, we recommend our people to use the publishing house as a safe place of deposit for money.

(4.) That we recommend to our brethren to give more attention to a resolution passed last year, in the following words; to-wit:—

“Resolved, That we deem it our duty to employ every means in our power to set a knowledge of this truth before this people, and that we recommend that special attention be paid to the circulation of our denominational books during the coming year, and that proper persons be employed to canvass the country for such works as ‘Thoughts on Daniel and the Revelation,’ ‘History of the Sabbath,’ ‘Constitutional Amendment,’ and other works calculated to create an interest in the third angel’s message.”

The meeting then adjourned *sine die*.

W. K. VICKERY, Sec.

PROCEEDINGS OF THE S. D. A. EDUCATIONAL SOCIETY.

NINTH ANNUAL SESSION.

PURSUANT to appointment, the stockholders of the S. D. A. Educational Society assembled in the Tabernacle at Battle Creek, Nov. 14, 1883, at 9 A. M., for the transaction of business pertaining to the Society. Eld. S. N. Haskell opened the meeting by prayer.

Proceeding to an organization, it was ascertained that there were 79 stockholders present, representing 524 shares in person; 899 shares were represented by proxy, making a total of 1,423 shares represented at the meeting.

The treasurer’s report for the year ending July 1, 1883, was then read as follows:—

TREASURER'S REPORT.

RECEIPTS.

On donations and shares,	\$245 00
" tuition,	7 45
" rent,	543 09
" sales of real estate,	300 00
" book sales,	40
" interest,	29 85
" <i>College Record</i> ,	86 82
" diplomas,	10 50
" notes issued,	5,052 50
Total,	\$6,275 61

DISBURSEMENTS.

For teachers' salaries for previous year,	\$161 50
" incidental expenses,	85 47
" repairs and improvements,	61 50
" printing,	5 25
" " of <i>College Record</i> for previous year,	104 12
" library,	13 50
" tuition refunded,	533 06
" settlement of teachers' claims,	191 50
" taxes,	85 08
" interest,	542 48
" insurance,	27 35
" notes redeemed,	1,195 98
" paid <i>Review and Herald</i> ,	3,258 28
" legal advice,	10 00
Total,	\$6,275 61

FINANCIAL STANDING.

Real Estate, { College campus,	\$12,400 00
" { " buildings,	28,334 50
" { Cottages,	4,500 00
Philosophical apparatus,	1,150 00
Museum,	600 00
Library, books, and stationary,	1,339 00
Due on good accounts,	675 67
Total,	\$49,049 17

LIABILITIES.

Out-standing notes,		\$9,002 50
Net assets, June 30, 1882,	\$40,959 71	
Net loss,	913 04	
Present worth,		\$40,046 67

\$49,049 17 \$49,049 17

W. C. SISLEY, Treasurer.

I have examined the above, and believe it to be correct.

A. R. HENRY, Auditor.

After remarks by the Chair, explaining some points of the above statement, the report was accepted.

The remainder of the time of this meeting was spent in listening to very interesting remarks from Eld. Littlejohn, the President of the College, and from W. C. White and Sr. White about the College and educational interests. Referring to the opening of the College, the influences which led to its closing, and its recent re-opening, Sr. White expressed the hope that the blessing of God would attend the work there, so that it might carry out the design for which it was started.

The object of having a college was to furnish a place where the young could be educated to go out and labor for God. Even as the fear of God is the beginning of wisdom, so the Bible should be studied in order to gain an education that will be of lasting benefit to the young. The time should be divided up between study and work, so as to furnish physical as well as mental development, and better advancement would be seen if this plan were followed out.

The Chair having been empowered to appoint the usual committees, J. Fargo, S. H. Lane, and O. A. Olsen were named as the Committee on Nominations; and W. C. White, U. Smith, and W. H. Littlejohn as the Committee on Resolutions.

At the second meeting, the Committee on Resolutions presented the following report:—

Resolved, That we express our gratitude to God for the re-opening of our College, and that we recognize his hand in the rapid increase in the number of students since the commencement of the term, and the exceptional good order which has characterized their deportment thus far.

Whereas, In our last annual session a resolution was passed to the effect that the trustees make provision for a suitable boarding-house for the students; also for the performance of labor on the part of the students; and as far as possible, for the conducting of the College upon a plan which shall harmonize in all respects with the light which God has given us upon this point through the testimonies; and—

Whereas, The carrying out of that resolution will involve the expenditure of fifteen to twenty thousand dollars; therefore—

Resolved, That we proceed to raise \$25,000 during the coming year, in subscriptions to the capital stock, to be used in paying the present indebtedness and in making the proposed improvements.

Whereas, The teaching of the Scriptures, and the training of ministers, missionaries, colporters, Bible-readers, and teachers for auxiliary schools should be the leading object of our College; and—

Whereas, We believe these branches of instruction will never be self-sustaining; and—

Whereas, There are many worthy persons who could be fitted for usefulness, and many laborers whose usefulness would be greatly increased, by a few months' study in our College; and—

Whereas, Many of these are not able to meet all the expenses of the necessary schooling; therefore—

Resolved, That we raise an Endowment Fund of \$50,000, to be loaned to our various institutions at five per cent; this fund to be controlled by the General Conference Committee, and the interest to be used as follows: First, To assist in meeting the expenses of the Biblical instruction at the College; Secondly, To assist those young people and those laborers who have proved their devotion to the cause, and their ability to serve it, and who need assistance to secure that education and training necessary to qualify them to labor successfully in advancing the present truth.

Resolved, That the address on education delivered to this body by Sr. E. G. White, on the forenoon of Nov. 14, be published in the *Review*, provided her consent can be obtained.

Whereas, There should be in the College a class for the instruction of mis-

sonary workers, conducted by some one who has had practical experience in this work ; therefore—

Resolved, That we recommend the trustees to select a suitable person to conduct these classes, and provide the most favorable advantages for becoming a successful instructor in this work.

These resolutions were considered separately and adopted, a lively interest being manifested in the recommendations introduced, especially the second and third resolutions.

The following names were then presented for trustees of the Society for the coming year : Geo. I. Butler, W. H. Littlejohn, A. R. Henry, W. H. Hall, J. H. Kellogg, H. W. Kellogg, W. C. Sisley. Being balloted upon, these names were nominated by a large majority, and the nominees were declared duly elected.

Meeting adjourned.

A. B. OYEN, *Sec.*

GEO. I. BUTLER, *Pres.*

THE HEALTH REFORM INSTITUTE.

SEVENTEENTH ANNUAL SESSION.

THE stockholders of the Health Reform Institute met for their seventeenth annual session at Battle Creek, Mich., Nov. 15, 1883, at 9 A. M. The President, Eld. S. N. Haskell, in the chair. Eld. J. N. Loughborough opened the meeting by prayer. On motion, the reading of the minutes of the last session was waived.

The roll being called, it was ascertained that two hundred and forty-five shares were represented by stockholders in person, and five hundred and thirty-seven by proxies. Thus a majority of the stock was represented.

While the number of shares represented at the meeting was being ascertained, very interesting and instructive remarks were made by Sr. White, respecting the objects of the institution, the importance of the health reform as a branch of this work, and the manner in which the institution should be conducted. She expressed herself as greatly pleased with its improved religious tone, and spoke particularly of the need of a larger number of consecrated and efficient workers in this department.

The Treasurer's report, being called for, it was presented as follows:—

RESOURCES AND LIABILITIES, OCT. 1, 1883.

RESOURCES.

Real estate,
House furnishings,
Farm stock, tools, etc.
Bills receivable,

\$126,326 72
24,511 45
967 00
10,443 57

Fuel,	1,615 00
Gasoline,	85 90
Evaporator,	1,000 00
Medical supplies,	1,000 00
Instruments and apparatus,	4,400 00
Expense account (articles on hand charged to this account),	1,639 15
Food supplies,	4,330 37
Sanitary supplies,	698 53
Good Health plates, sheets, etc.	92 30
Good accounts,	13,461 59
Cash on hand in safe,	866 67

LIABILITIES.

Notes payable,		\$71,628 14
Accounts payable,		6,639 36
Net worth, Oct. 2, 1882,	\$92,590 17	
Net gain for 1883,	15,250 59	
Net worth, Oct. 1, 1883,		118,840 76
		\$101,508 26 - \$101,503 26

LOSS AND GAIN STATEMENT FOR 1883.

		Dr.	Cr.
Sbars,			\$15 00
Loss and gain,			69 22
Charity—board and treatment gratis,	\$5,631 28		
Donations (including tithes),	2,857 57		
		\$2,773 71	
Farm stock, tools, etc., inventory Oct. 1, 1882,	1,095 00		
Additions to Oct. 1, 1883,	3 50		
	1,098 50		
Inventory Oct. 1, 1883,	937 00		
		111 50	
Fuel—cost,		6,443 59	
Sales,	889 72		
Inventory,	1,615 00		
		1,704 72	
Gasoline—cost,		4,738 37	
Sales,	18 60		
Inventory,	85 90		
		104 50	
Medical supplies—cost,	2,433 89		1,166 13
Inventory,	1,000 00		
		1,433 89	
Interest,		8,030 54	
Advertising, postage, circulars, etc.,		1,439 84	
Instruments and apparatus—cost,	4,763 91		
Inventory,	4,400 00		
		363 91	
Board and treatment,			83,328 29
Expense—outlay,	13,793 24		
Inventory,	1,639 15		
		12,104 09	
Food supplies—cost,		22,216 26	
Sales,	4,175 61		
Inventory,	4,330 37		
		8,505 98	
Laundry,		13,110 28	
Labor,		25,090 63	3,924 73

Sanitary supplies—sales,	3,741 98	
Inventory,	698 53	
Cost,	4,440 46	
	8,652 86	
Good Health receipts,	3,178 31	787 00
Inventory,	92 30	
Cost,	3,270 61	
	3,252 50	
Discount,	1,824 00	18 11
Net gain,	15,260 59	
	\$38,142 95—\$38,142 95	

G. H. MURPHY, *Treasurer.*

I hereby certify that I have examined the accounts of the Sanitarium, and find them to have been correctly kept; and I believe the above is a correct statement of the business of last year.

A. H. MASON, *Auditor.*

Attention was called to the fact that the report as given gave hardly a fair statement of the real earnings of the institution, as over three thousand dollars of the earnings of this year are offset by old accounts supposed to be good at the time of last year's report, but this year thrown out of the statement of resources as worthless. Improvements to a considerable amount have been made which does not appear in the report, the money expended for the same having been charged to the expense account.

The unexpected financial prosperity which has attended the institution during the last two years, has enabled the managers to pay off the bonded debt, thus releasing the property of the institution from incumbrance, and greatly improving its financial condition. The remaining indebtedness is almost wholly in the hands of the friends of the institution, in the form of notes bearing a low rate of interest. The present prospect is that in four years the institution may be wholly free from debt.

REPORT OF THE MEDICAL SUPERINTENDENT.

The medical report being called for, Dr. Kellogg made somewhat lengthy remarks respecting the manner in which the medical work of the institution is conducted, the numerous improvements in various departments, etc., and dwelt particularly upon the great need of young men and women who are willing to devote their lives unselfishly to this department of the cause. The difficulty has been that young men have been willing to remain only so long as their own selfish interests could be advanced. The opportunities for gaining experience at the Sanitarium, and the reputation which the institution has acquired, enable those who are connected with it, even for two or three years only, to carry away with them such a degree of influence as to render them capable of earning elsewhere much

more than the institution, with its low prices, can afford to pay as salaries. Many flattering inducements are constantly offered, not only to our physicians, but to attendants and nurses, and to all connected with the medical department of the institution, and unless there is a real consecration to the work, and an earnest interest in it as a philanthropic enterprise, the temptation to separate from the work, and satisfy personal ambitions by endeavoring to build up an independent work even at the expense of this, becomes too enticing to be resisted.

The urgent necessity for additional buildings for the accommodation of patients was referred to. The present building, which is the only one suitable for patients in the winter season, is crowded to its utmost capacity. Even the small sky-light rooms, lighted only by small windows in the roof, and intended only for store-rooms, are now occupied by patients, four of these small rooms accommodating seven patients, who prefer these warm though unattractive quarters to the cold, unventilated cottages at a distance from the institution. It was stated that the large new building had never been able to accommodate all the patients at any time since its erection, and during the last summer, when the total number reached at one time more than two hundred, only about one-third of the patients could be accommodated in the main building. Another structure of equal size would be none too large to accommodate our present patronage, even with our several cottages, as it is at present necessary to rent nine cottages in addition to our own, and these are greatly scattered, and only to be obtained on short leases, as most of them are liable to be sold at any time. The expense and trouble of caring for patients in cottages is very great, and the embarrassment experienced by those who have to bear responsibilities at the institution on account of the inability to properly accommodate patients in the winter season, is exceedingly great.

Gratitude was expressed for the improved condition of the religious interests of the institution, to which the labors of Eld. Hutchins and others had chiefly contributed. The hope was expressed that a sufficient number of persons of moral stamina and influence might be connected with the institution to maintain a high moral tone and a strong religious influence. A larger number of such persons is needed, although the institution is at present better situated in this respect than ever before.

The following is a summary of the medical work of the year :—

Number of patients treated,	5000
" " surgical operations performed,	175

On motion, the report was accepted.

The Chair was empowered to appoint the usual and other committees, which were named as follows: On Nominations, J. B.

Goodrich, R. F. Andrews, E. R. Jones ; on Resolutions, W. H. Littlejohn, A. S. Hutchins, L. M. Hall ; on Constitution, By-laws, and Re-organization, J. H. Kellogg, A. R. Henry ; on Applications from the Sick Poor, G. H. Murphy, Harrison Grant, J. Fargo.

Adjourned to call of Chair.

SECOND MEETING, Nov. 19, AT 5 P. M.—Prayer by Eld. J. B. Goodrich. Minutes of last meeting read and approved.

The Committee on Resolutions reported as follows :—

Resolved, That we recognize with gratitude the marked prosperity of the Sanitarium under its present management which has enabled the trustees to pay the bonds of indebtedness ; and that we take great satisfaction in expressing our conviction that it offers greater inducements to those who are in need of medical treatment than any other institute of like character in this country.

Whereas, It is a fact that in many of the so-called health institutions the religion of Jesus Christ is either ignored altogether, or brought into contempt by the introduction into them of such amusements, recreations, and exercises as are positively demoralizing in their tendencies ; therefore—

Resolved, That we find occasion for devout gratitude to God that he has put it into the hearts of those who have the management of the Battle Creek Sanitarium, not only to exclude from its methods of treatment everything which is irreligious in its character, but also to surround the patients by such positive spiritual influences as are found in the preaching of the word of God, prayer-meetings, Sabbath-schools, religious papers, tracts, etc., etc.

Whereas, The managers of the Sanitarium have been greatly harassed in time past by unworthy members of our own denomination, who, without invitation or recommendation from officers of the Conference to which they belong, have come to the Sanitarium for the purpose of receiving treatment as charity patients ; therefore—

Resolved, That all such persons are hereby notified that the failure on their part to obtain from the officers of their respective Conferences certificates to the effect that they belong to the class known as worthy poor, will be considered as presumptive evidence that they are not such individuals as are worthy of such certificate, and therefore are not entitled to charitable treatment at the Sanitarium.

Whereas, The Sanitarium, though financially prosperous, is still encumbered more or less with outstanding debts ; and—

Whereas, It would be unreasonable under these circumstances to expect it to bear the burden of treating all poor invalids among us without charge ; therefore—

Resolved, That we express it as our conviction that in cases where the Sanitarium is willing to bear half the expense of treating any of the worthy poor, it is no more than just that the Conference Committee of the Conference to which these persons belong should obligate said Conference to pay to the Sanitarium one-half of the regular charges for treatment of such poor persons.

Whereas, The health reform is inseparably connected with our denominational work ; and—

Whereas, *Good Health* is a journal which is by far the ablest and best exponent of these principles now published ; therefore—

Resolved, That it should have a place in every family of Seventh-day Adventists, and that our brethren, in extending its circulation among those not of our

faith, are but preparing the way for the reception of the other great truths of our message.

Resolved, That we express our confidence in the ability and integrity of Dr. J. H. Kellogg, the physician-in-chief at the Sanitarium, and that we pledge him our active sympathy and hearty co-operation in bearing the weighty responsibilities and performing the arduous duties which devolve upon him in his official position.

Whereas, It has pleased God since the last session of this body to remove by death Dr. Phebe M. Lamson from the responsible position which she has held in connection with the Sanitarium since it was founded ; therefore—

Resolved, That while we mourn her loss as one which is common to all those who love the prosperity of that institution, we will ever cherish as a pleasing memory the recollection of her faithful labors, her self-sacrificing spirit, her meek and quiet deportment, and her unwavering fidelity in the service of her Master.

Whereas, The information obtained by Dr. Kellogg on his recent visit to Europe has enabled him to introduce such new and improved methods of treatment into the Sanitarium as have resulted in an increased patronage to the institution ; therefore—

Resolved, That we recommend the Directors to refund him the amount of expense incurred in obtaining this information from the funds of the institution.

Resolved, That we hereby express our hearty appreciation of the labors of Mrs. Kellogg in assisting the Doctor in his editorial work on Good Health, and also of her labors to advance the interests of a healthful dietary in the Sanitarium.

Resolved, That we heartily approve of the modest, healthful, uniform style of dress that is being adopted by the lady helpers at the Sanitarium.

Moved that the resolutions be adopted by considering each separately.—Carried.

The resolutions were then separately considered, several being amended, and all finally adopted as they appear above.

The Committee on Nominations reported in favor of the following persons for directors for the ensuing year : S. N. Haskell, J. H. Kellogg, A. R. Henry, W. H. Hall, G. H. Murphy, J. Fargo, L. M. Hall.

The shareholders then proceeded to ballot on this nomination, which resulted in the election of the persons named.

The Committee appointed on By-laws and Re-organization reported that they had carefully considered the matter, seeking legal advice on the subject, and were of the opinion that no change could be effected without involving difficulties which rendered such a change unadvisable.

The committee recommended the following changes in the By-laws, which were severally considered and unanimously adopted:—

1. Amend Section 1 of Article I, by substituting the word *rational* for *hygiene* so as to read as follows : “ The object of this institution is to treat disease upon *rational* principles, and give instruction in the recovery and preservation of health.”

2. Repeal Section 2 of Article II., which reads, "The treatment and instruction of the patients shall be for such compensation as the Board of Directors shall deem just and proper."

3. Repeal Section 3 of Article II., which reads as follows : "No person drawing any salary from the institution shall be eligible to the office of director."

4. Amend Section 6 of Article II., which reads, "The directors of this institution shall have power to purchase and hold real estate, and convey the same, and to erect, alter, or improve such buildings as may be necessary for the business of the Institute, by adding the following words : *And to add such facilities for treatment as may in their judgment seem to be required.*

5. Amend Section 1 of Article III. to read, "Sanitary and Medical Department of the Institute."

6. Amend Section 2 of Article IV. to read as follows : "It shall be the duty of the Treasurer to take charge of all the moneys of the Institute, and to keep an accurate account of the receipts and disbursements of the same, and report as often as required by them to do so to the Board of Directors, and annually to the meeting of the stockholders."

7. Amend Section 1 of Article VII. to read as follows : "Meetings of the Board may be held at any time on the written call of any two members thereof, by personal notice to said members, or by written notice left at the residence of such members ; but in case any member is a non-resident of the city of Battle Creek, it shall not be necessary to give any notice, written or personal, to such Director : *provided always* that a majority of the Board are notified. Upon the delivery of the written call to the Secretary, it shall be his duty to notify the Directors of such meeting."

8. Amend Section 5 of Article XI. as follows

"PROXY.

"Know all men by these presents that I _____ of _____, owning _____ shares of capital stock in the Health Reform Institute of Battle Creek, Michigan, do hereby appoint _____ my attorney for me and in my stead, to vote as my proxy, upon all questions that may come before any meetings of the stockholders of said Institute, according to the number of votes I should be entitled to cast if then personally present. This proxy shall be in force until it is revoked in writing.

"Witness my signature, _____."

9. Amend Section 2 of Article XII. to read as follows : "No capital stock of the Institute shall be withdrawn or refunded to the stockholders."

10. Add a new section to Article XII. to stand as Section 3, the same to read as follows : "All transfers of stock shall be made by

written assignment on the Treasurer's transfer book, subscribed by the assignor or his duly authorized attorney, accompanied by a surrender of the certificate granted for the stock."

Moved and carried, that the amendments to the By-laws, as presented by Dr. J. H. Kellogg, be adopted.

Moved and carried, that a sufficient number of copies of the By-laws, as amended, be printed to supply each stockholder with a copy, and as many additional as the Secretary may deem necessary for future use.

After remarks by Dr. Kellogg on the importance and object of the training school for nurses, to be established at the Sanitarium, it was moved and carried that this enterprise be encouraged and supported.

Adjourned *sine die*.
W. H. Hall, Sec.

S. N. Haskell, Pres.

At a subsequent meeting of the newly elected Board of Directors, the following officers were elected for the ensuing year: President, Eld. S. N. Haskell; Vice-President, J. H. Kellogg; Treasurer, G. H. Murphy; Secretary, W. H. Hall; Auditor, A. R. Henry; Medical Superintendent, Dr. J. H. Kellogg; Matron, Mrs. L. M. Hall.

At the same meeting a standing committee on "Loans and Legacies" was appointed. The committee consisted of the following persons: Eld. S. N. Haskell, A. R. Henry, Eld. J. Fargo.

W. H. Hall, Sec.

GENERAL SABBATH-SCHOOL ASSOCIATION PROCEEDINGS.

SIXTH ANNUAL SESSION.

THE first meeting of the sixth annual session of this Association convened in the Tabernacle at Battle Creek, Mich., Nov. 10, at 6:30 p. m. In the absence of the President, the Vice-President, A. B. Oyen, called the meeting to order. Eld. Haskell offered prayer. On motion, all delegates to the General Conference were received as delegates to this body. The report of the last annual meeting was read and approved. The Chair being authorized to appoint the usual committees, the following were announced: On Nominations, M. B. Miller, S. H. Lane, John Fulton; on Resolutions, J. O. Corliss, W. C. White, O. A. Olsen. *

The Executive Committee having previously arranged topics for discussion, the following were presented: How to study the lesson, by Eld. M. H. Brown; Teachers' meetings, by W. C. White; Sab-

Bath-school Conventions, by A. D. Olsen ; Camp-meeting Sabbath-schools, by J. H. Durland.

Several others joined in the discussion of these questions. Eld. J. H. Cook and Bro. W. K. Loughborough made interesting remarks relative to children's meetings, after which the meeting adjourned to the call of the Chair.

SECOND MEETING, NOV. 20, AT 9 A. M.—Prayer by Eld. R. F. Andrews. After the reading of the minutes of the previous meeting, about forty minutes were spent in answering questions.

On motion, Eld. S. N. Haskell and D. A. Robinson were requested to prepare a Bible-reading on the subject of Sabbath offerings.

The following resolution was then adopted :—

Whereas, There are many of the less studious members of our schools who, in preparing their lessons, study the synopsis of the lesson, as printed in the *Instructors*, without a study of the Bible itself ; therefore—

Resolved, That we recommend to the careful consideration of the Executive Committee, and the lesson-writer in particular, the advisability of discontinuing the synopsis for a time, and using in its stead the references to the Scripture proofs.

The Nominating Committee reported as follows : For President, W. C. White ; Vice-President, O. A. Olsen ; Recording Secretary, D. A. Robinson ; Corresponding Secretary, Winnie Loughborough ; Assistant Corresponding Secretary, Mrs. M. K. White ; Executive Committee, W. C. White, O. A. Olsen, G. H. Bell, E. B. Miller, R. M. Kilgore ; Publishing Committee, W. C. White, Dr. E. J. Waggoner, G. H. Bell.

The meeting then adjourned *sine die*.

A. B. OYEN, *Vice-Pres.*

D. A. ROBINSON, *Recording Sec.*

PROCEEDINGS OF THE AMERICAN HEALTH AND TEMPERANCE ASSOCIATION.

FIFTH ANNUAL SESSION.

THE fifth annual session of the American Health and Temperance Association held its first meeting in the Tabernacle at Battle Creek, Mich., at 7 P. M., Nov. 18, 1883. The meeting was called to order by the President, Dr. J. H. Kellogg. Eld. S. N. Haskell offered prayer. In the absence of the Secretary, D. A. Robinson acted in that capacity. The report of the Secretary was read and approved. On motion, the Chair was empowered to appoint the usual committees.

The President expressed his gratitude in being able to say that the Association was still alive, and that progress could be reported. The report showed quite an increase in membership. "We need not," he added, "be ashamed of our position. We have not a single principle that is not scientific, and we should not fear to talk out these principles. Four thousand outside of our denomination are subscribers to *Good Health*."

Eld. Loughborough spoke for the cause in England, extending greetings from several societies there to this Association. Interesting remarks were also made by Elds. J. O. Corliss and A. S. Hutchins, Prof. Veysey, Eld. Van Horn, Dr. Hill, Eld. Hanson, I. E. Kimball, Mrs. E. B. Lane, and Mrs. J. A. Owen.

The Chair announced as a Committee on Resolutions, J. N. Loughborough, J. O. Corliss, I. D. Van Horn; on Nominations, S. H. Lane, John Fulton, D. A. Robinson.

After a spirited discussion relative to increasing the circulation of *Good Health*, the meeting adjourned to call of Chair.

SECOND MEETING, TUESDAY, 2:30 P. M.—Prayer by Eld. J. N. Loughborough. Minutes of last meeting read and approved.

The Committee on Resolutions presented the following, which were adopted:—

Resolved, That we hereby express our gratitude for the success that has attended the efforts of the Health and Temperance Association, not only in securing so large a number of total pledges among S. D. Adventists, but also in forwarding the work outside the church.

Resolved, That we hereby express our appreciation of the indefatigable labors of Dr. J. H. Kellogg in promoting the cause of health and temperance. Especially would we call attention to what has been done for the journal, *Good Health*, and we hereby pledge ourselves to second his efforts by doing all in our power to increase the circulation of said journal.

The Committee on Nominations reported as follows: For President, J. H. Kellogg; Vice-President, D. A. Robinson; Secretary and Treasurer, Mrs. J. H. Kellogg; Executive Committee, J. H. Kellogg, S. N. Haskell, W. C. White.

A motion was adopted authorizing the Executive Committee to appoint Corresponding Secretaries where it may seem advisable.

Voted, That the Executive Committee be authorized to appoint lecturers in each State.

RECORDING SECRETARY'S ANNUAL REPORT.

There are twenty-six State and Conference organizations acting under the auspices of the American Health and Temperance Association. Of these State societies, only four have responded to the call for a membership report, and these four report an increase

during the year as follows : Texas, 47 ; Pennsylvania, 30 ; Ohio, 21 ; Illinois, 115 ; making the total membership in Texas, 338 ; Pennsylvania, 420 ; Ohio, 480 ; Illinois, 484. According to the reports of last year, the membership in California aggregated 1,668 ; New York, 729 ; Wisconsin, 1,300 ; Iowa, 1,098 ; Kansas, 680 ; Vermont, 333 ; and the Upper Columbia Conference, 281 ; which, together with the reports from other States in previous years, and the increase reported in the four States named, makes a known total of 10,433 members. This, together with the estimated number of members in societies not reported, and the probable increase during the last two years, must make the entire membership between sixteen and eighteen thousand.

Of the known members, over two-thirds are signers of the teetotal pledge, quite a large number of them being reformed tea and coffee drinkers. A large per cent of the added members in the four States which have reported this year were persons formerly addicted to the use of tea and coffee.

At the Sanitarium, a Health and Temperance Club was organized early in the year for the especial benefit of the helpers of the institution, nearly all of whom have become members, and signers of the teetotal pledge. As the family of helpers numbers nearly one hundred at all times, and is constantly changing, there have been not less than one hundred and fifty members during the year. Most of these have signed the teetotal pledge, dispensed with all animal food, and adopted the two-meal system, while the majority of the lady helpers, to the number of fifty-six, have adopted the healthful mode of dress advocated by the society.

TREASURER'S REPORT.

Cash on hand Jan. 16, 1883,	\$634.44
Receipts during the year,	87.60
Total,	\$722.04
Paid out during the year,	15.70
Cash on hand,	\$706.34
Adjourned <i>sine die</i> .	

J. H. KELLOGG, *Pres.*

D. A. ROBINSON, *Sec. pro tem.*

CONSTITUTION OF THE GENERAL CONFERENCE.

AS AMENDED TO JAN. 1, 1884.

For the purpose of securing unity and efficiency in labor, and promoting the general interests of the cause of present truth, and of perfecting the organization of the Seventh-day Adventists, we, the delegates from the several State conferences, hereby proceed to

organize a General Conference, and adopt the following Constitution for the government thereof:—

ARTICLE I.—This Conference shall be called The General Conference of Seventh-day Adventists, and shall be composed of delegates from the different State conferences, and such ministers as shall have been employed as missionaries during any part of the year.

ART. II.—SECTION 1. The officers of this Conference shall be a President, a Recording Secretary, a Corresponding Secretary, a Treasurer, and an Executive Committee of five of whom the President shall be one.

SEC. 2. The Executive Committee shall have power to fill any vacancies that may occur in their number by death, resignation, or otherwise.

ART. III.—The duties of the President and Secretary shall be such as usually pertain to those offices.

ART. IV.—It shall be the duty of the Treasurer to receive and disburse means under the direction of the Executive Committee, and to keep an account of the same, and make a full report thereof to the regular meetings of the Conference.

ART. V.—SEC. 1. It shall be the duty of the Executive Committee to take the general supervision of all ministerial labor, and see that the same is properly distributed; and they shall take the special supervision of all missionary labor, and as a missionary board shall have the power to decide where such labor is needed, and who shall go as missionaries to perform the same; and they shall audit and settle accounts with ministers and others in the employ of the Conference.

SEC. 2. Means for missionary operations may be received by donation from State conferences, churches, or individuals; and the Committee are authorized to call for means when needed.

SEC. 3. When any State conference desires ministerial labor from a minister not a resident within the bounds of such conference, their request shall be made to the General Conference Executive Committee, and ministers sent by said Committee shall be considered under the jurisdiction of the conference committee of such State: *Provided*, 1. That if such minister consider the State committee inefficient, or their action so far wrong as to render his labor ineffectual, he may appeal to the General Conference Executive Committee: *Provided*, 2. That if such State committee consider such minister inefficient, they may appeal to the General Conference Committee, who shall decide on the matter of complaint, and take such action as they may think proper.

SEC. 4. The General Conference Executive Committee shall have power during the intervals between the yearly meetings to license ministers who may be raised up in mission fields.

SEC. 5. It shall be the duty of the ministers and others in the employ of the General Conference to make a written report to each annual meeting thereof of each day's occupation during the Conference year, or such portion of the year as they may have been in the employ of the Conference.

SEC. 6. It shall be the duty of the Conference to select a committee of six delegates who have not been in the employ of the Conference the preceding year, to act with the Executive Committee in the examination and settlement of accounts.

ART. VI.—Each State conference shall be entitled to one delegate in the General Conference, and one additional delegate for every twenty delegates in the State conference, such delegates to the General Conference to be chosen by the State conferences or their committees: *Provided*, That the delegates to such

State conferences be elected according to the following ratio; to-wit, Each church to the number of twenty members or under, shall be entitled to one delegate, and one delegate for every additional fifteen members.

ART. VII.—The officers shall be elected at the regular meetings of the Conference, and shall hold their offices for the term of one year, or until their successors are chosen.

ART. VIII.—SEC. 1. The regular meetings of the Conference shall be held annually, and the time and place of holding the same shall be determined by the Executive Committee, by whom due notice thereof shall be given through the *Review*.

SEC. 2. Special meetings may be called at the option of the Committee.

ART. IX.—This Constitution may be altered or amended by a three-fourths vote of the members present at any meeting.

CONSTITUTION FOR STATE CONFERENCES.

Whereas, We have before us the great work of disseminating light upon the commandments of God, the faith of Jesus, and the truths connected with the third angel's message; and—

Whereas, Order, union, and concentration of action in the dissemination of these truths is of the utmost importance; therefore—

Resolved, That we adopt the following Constitution, as recommended by the General Conference of Seventh-day Adventists, assembled at Battle Creek, Mich., May 20, 1863:—

ARTICLE I.—This Conference shall be known as the ——— Conference of Seventh-day Adventists, and shall be composed of all ministers in good standing, and delegates of organized churches within its limits.

ART. II.—SEC. 1. The officers of this Conference shall be a President, Secretary, Treasurer, and an Executive Committee of three, of whom the President shall be one; and they shall be elected annually.

SEC. 2. The duties of the President and Secretary shall be such as usually pertain to these offices.

SEC. 3. It shall be the duty of the Treasurer to keep an account of the receipts and disbursements of the Conference funds, to pay out the same under the directions of the Executive Committee, and to make an annual report thereof at the regular meetings of the Conference.

SEC. 4. It shall be the duty of the Executive Committee to appoint through the *Review* the time and place of the annual Conferences, and to call special Conferences whenever in their judgment it may be needful so to do; to call on the churches and scattered brethren for means when needed, and to disburse the same; to take the general supervision of all tent operations, and property belonging to the Conference; to audit and settle accounts with ministers and others in the employ of the Conference; and to exercise a general watch-care over all matters pertaining to the interests of the cause within the bounds of the Conference.

ART. III.—SEC. 1. Conference funds shall be raised from the proceeds of Systematic Benevolence, and by gifts and donations.

SEC. 2. We recommend that all churches belonging to this Conference adopt the plan of Systematic Benevolence on the tithing principle, as set forth on the first page of our s. b. books.

SEC. 3. The churches and scattered brethren within the bounds of this Conference will be expected to pledge to the Executive Committee the amount that they will give each month during the Conference year, for the support of the ministers and tent operations, and for such other purposes as may be necessary for the advancement of the cause; said sums to be paid to the Treasurer monthly when convenient so to do, or at the commencement of every quarter; viz., on the first of April, July, October, and January, except when it be preferable to give it, or a portion of it, directly to preachers who labor among them.

SEC. 4. The churches will be expected to make a report to the Secretary at the end of each quarter, of the amount they have sent to the Treasurer or paid to preachers during such quarter.

SEC. 5. It shall be the duty of ministers to report to the Secretary at the end of each quarter the amount they have received and expended during such quarter, and at the end of each year they shall make a *written* report to the regular meetings of the Conference of the entire amount of their receipts and expenditures during such Conference year.

ART. IV.—SEC. 1. When any church or scattered brethren wish ministerial labor in their vicinity, their call shall be made to the Executive Committee.

SEC. 2. It shall be the duty of the churches in this Conference to send a written report to the regular meetings of the Conference of their standing, their losses and additions during the year, also the yearly amount of their s. b. fund.

ART. V.—SEC. 1. It shall be the duty of the Conference to determine who are the approved ministers within the bounds thereof, to grant suitable credentials to the same at each regular meeting; and during the interval of such meetings the Executive Committee shall perform such duties.

SEC. 2.—Those who feel it their duty to improve their gifts as messengers, or preachers, shall first lay their exercises of mind before the Conference Committee, to receive a license from them, if the Committee consider them qualified.

ART. VI.—It shall be the duty of the ministers of this Conference to make a *written* report to each annual meeting thereof, of their labors each week during the Conference year.

ART. VII.—SEC. 1. The delegates to this Conference shall be elected according to the following ratio: Each church to the number of twenty members, or under, shall be entitled to one delegate, and one delegate for every additional fifteen members.

SEC. 2. In case all the delegates to which any church is entitled do not attend the Conference, the delegates attending may cast the full number of votes to which said church is entitled.

ART. VIII.—This Constitution may be amended at any regular meeting of the Conference by a two-thirds vote of the members present, *provided* such amendment shall not conflict with the Constitution of the General Conference.

Voted, That this Conference issue a pamphlet containing the minutes of this Conference, together with the address on organization issued by the Battle Creek Conference of Oct. 5 and 6, 1861; also that the minutes of this Conference be published in the *Review*.

Voted, That we recommend the State Conferences to publish in pamphlet form the minutes of their proceedings, and distribute to their churches.

Adjourned *sine die*.

U. SMITH, Secretary.

JOHN BYINGTON, Chairman.

REVISED CONSTITUTION OF THE INTERNATIONAL TRACT AND MISSIONARY SOCIETY.

ARTICLE I.—This Society shall be known as the International Tract and Missionary Society.*

ART. II.—The objects of this Society are, 1. To take an oversight of the various State tract societies, and to suggest such plans as will secure uniformity of action; 2. To assist State societies in the management of city missions; 3. To secure an extensive and systematic distribution of our publications in foreign countries, and in those portions of our own land not included in State organizations; 4. To place upon steamers and vessels sailing to different portions of the world such reading matter as is thought to be best adapted to promote the interests of present truth; 5. To send packages of our publications to the different ports visited by ships. In short, the object of the Society is to seek out and make use of every possible means by which the light of present truth can be carried to all portions of the world.

ART. III.—The officers of this Society shall consist of a President, a Vice-President, a Secretary (who shall also act as Treasurer), three Assistant Secretaries or more, and an Executive Board of seven, of which the President, Vice-President, and Secretary shall be members.

ART. IV.—It is the duty of the Executive Board to carry out the decisions of the Society; to furnish publications and employ agents as they may see fit, and also to audit all accounts.

ART. V.—All persons paying the sum of ten dollars shall become life-members of this Society, and shall receive certificates of life-membership.† They shall also be entitled to all the privileges of members of State societies.

ART. VI.—SEC. 1. This Society shall be represented by delegates and life-members.

SEC. 2. The State officers of any Tract and Missionary Society present shall be considered delegates. In the absence of State officers the deficiency may be supplied by persons from the same society, who may be present.

SEC. 3. Any company of Seventh-day Adventists organized according to the plan adopted by our State societies, not included in any conference tract organization, shall be entitled to one or more delegates, according to the number of districts in the organization.

ART. VII.—The funds of this Society shall consist of receipts for life-membership, and donations from societies and individuals.

ART. VIII.—SEC. 1. This Society shall convene annually for the election of officers and the transaction of necessary business, at such time and place as the President may appoint.

SEC. 2. Special meetings may be called by a majority of the Executive Board at such times and places as they shall deem necessary for the interests of the organization.

ART. IX.—This Constitution may be amended by a two-thirds' vote at any annual meeting.

* This Society was originally called, "The General Tract and Missionary Society of Seventh-day Adventists;" but at the annual session held in Roma, N. Y., December, 1882, the name was changed to "The International Tract and Missionary Society."

† Resolved, That Art. V. of the Constitution, gives the members of this Society no privileges in any local society above those of the local members. They may draw publications at the discretion of the local officers to be used while in that locality, and are expected to make donations toward meeting the expenses of the local society, according to their ability, the same as other members.

SEVENTH-DAY ADVENTIST STATISTICS, 1883.

Names of Conferences.	Ministers.	Licentiate.	Churches.	Members.	Tithes raised during the year.
California (including Nevada)	11	5	25	1185	\$11602 18
Canada	2	2	5	175	805 00
Colorado	2	2	4	106	750 00
Dakota	4	2	13	310	1573 42
Denmark, Sweden, & Norway	7	3	13	312	800 00
Illinois	7	3	30	641	4154 50
Indiana	8	9	29	730	2633 52
Iowa	15	5	50	1375	7192 94
Kansas	5	13	37	931	4493 33
Kentucky	2	1	5	63	800 00
Maine	3	2	23	380	1965 87
Michigan	26	28	131	3580	15130 51
Minnesota	9	8	50	1000	5703 87
Missouri	4	8	18	400	2033 51
Nebraska	5	..	24	545	4570 86
New England	3	5	24	518	5020 00
New York	8	8	29	768	4378 68
North Pacific	3	..	8	140	1584 45
Ohio	7	2	37	850	4598 90
Pennsylvania	6	8	22	448	5000 51
Tennessee	1	2	5	92	430 00
Texas	1	3	8	263	2409 00
Upper Columbia	2	2	6	185	1375 05
Vermont	1	4	13	388	1900 73
Virginia	1	3	3	86	225 00
Wisconsin	14	6	46	1429	5677 62
MISSIONS—					
Central European	3	..	*15	*223	*442 70
English	2	1	2	70	299 87
General Southern	8	4	5	201	*152 00
Totals	185	125	680	17436	\$ 96118 62
As given last year	167	134	650	17159	\$ 84261 36
Gain		1	20	267	\$ 12157 26

* Figures as given last year.

+ In the Seventh-day Adventist statistics, published in the *Review* of Dec. 11, 1883, the increase of membership during the year was given as two hundred and sixty-seven. This was according to reports returned from the different States; but these returns were evidently not complete; for our ministers have reported through the *Review* the past year, by actual count, making all due allowance for those that may possibly have been mentioned twice, and taking all general statements at their minimum value, *fourteen hundred and forty-nine* conversions. And the increase should present even a larger figure than this; for our churches are receiving additions aside from such meetings as are reported by our ministers, more than sufficient to cover all losses by death and apostasy.—*Review and Herald of Jan. 8, 1884.*



IMPORTANT EVENTS

IN CONNECTION WITH THE RISE AND PROGRESS OF THE THIRD
ANGEL'S MESSAGE.

1844. Oct. 22, tenth day of seventh month (Jewish time). 2300 days of Dan. 8:14 end.
First church of S. D. Adventists in Washington, N. H.
First Adventist preacher who proclaimed the Sabbath, T. M. Preble; second, J. B. Cook.
First true light on the Sanctuary, by O. R. L. Crozier, in *Day Dawn*.
1845. First two visions given to Miss Ellen G. Harmon, at Portland, Me., she being at that time seventeen years old.
Feb. 13, date of T. M. Preble's essay on the Sabbath.
Eld. Joseph Bates began the observance of the Sabbath.
1846. Aug. 30, marriage of Eld. James White and Ellen G. Harmon.
Autumn, both began the observance and proclamation of the Bible Sabbath.
Eld. G. W. Holt began the observance of the Sabbath.
1848. Important meeting in Western New York, in a barn of Bro. David Arnold.
1849. First paper, *Present Truth*, published by Eld. James White at Middletown, Conn.
Nov. 3, important meeting in Oswego, N. Y.
1850. *Advent Review*, a magazine of 48 pages printed at Auburn, N. Y., containing reviews of the 1843-4 movement, and article on the Sanctuary, by O. R. L. Crozier.
November, first number of *Advent Review and Sabbath Herald* issued at Paris, Me. Publishing Committee, Joseph Bates, S. W. Rhodes, J. N. Andrews, and James White. Published monthly, more or less regularly, till April 7, 1851.
Nov. 15, date of Eld. J. N. Andrews' first article on the Sabbath question. Eld. J. N. Andrews began active labor in the cause.
April 21, first article on Spiritual Gifts, by Eld. James White.
April 7, *Review* first issued as a semi-monthly.
1851. First article on United States in prophecy, or Rev. 13 and 14, by Eld. J. N. Andrews, in *Review* of May 19.
June 9, article on Matt. 25:1-12, by Eld. James White. "Shut Door" discussed.
Aug. 5, date of Vol. II., No. 1, *Review and Herald*, published at Saratoga Springs, N. Y. Committee, Joseph Bates, Hiram Edson, and J. N. Andrews. Editor, James White.
Eld. J. H. Waggoner enlisted in the message.
1852. May 6, date of No. 1, Vol. III., of *Review and Herald*, published at Rochester, N. Y. Publishing committee, Joseph Bates, J. N. Andrews, and Joseph Baker.
June 10, first article in *Review* from Sr. E. G. White.
August, first number of *Youth's Instructor* issued at Rochester, N. Y.
Sept. 2, date of H. Edson's article on connection of Rev. 7:1-3 with 14:9-12. First article on "The Seal."
Dec. 23, date of "Sanctuary, by J. N. Andrews."
Dec. 23, first obituary notices in *Review and Herald*.
1853. Jan 6, first article on "Church Organization" (selected).
Mar. 17, first article by U. Smith, entitled, "The Warning Voice of Time and Prophecy."
Apr. 14, article on "Shut Door," by J. W.

- "History of the Sabbath," by Eld. J. N. Andrews, begun.
 Sept. 8, *Review* began to be issued as a weekly.
1854. In *Review* of Mar. 28, article entitled "Gospel Order," by Eld. James White.
 July, Publishing Committee changed to J. N. Andrews, R. F. Cottrell, U. Smith.
1855. Sept. 19, second article by Sr. White, entitled, "Duty of Parents to their Children."
 First church-buildings erected at Buck's Bridge, N. Y., and Battle Creek, Mich.
 Sept. 25, action taken at a meeting in Battle Creek, Mich., to move the *Review* Office to that place.
 Office removed to Battle Creek, and established in a two-story wooden building, erected by the brethren for the purpose. Date of first number of *Review* issued in Battle Creek, Dec. 4, 1855.
 Nov. 16, first General Conference held in Battle Creek, Mich., for the purpose of making a choice of those brethren who should conduct the *Review*, and to consider other matters of vital interest to the prosperity of the cause. Henry Lyon, Cyrenus Smith, and D. R. Palmer were chosen Publishing Committee; Uriah Smith, resident editor; J. N. Andrews, James White, J. H. Waggoner, R. F. Cottrell, and Stephen Pierce, corresponding editors.
- Dec. 4, article on "Time for Commencing the Sabbath," by J. N. Andrews. The first true theory presented in *Review* in full.
1856. Committee appointed to prepare a tract on the Sabbath, to be printed in German.
1857. Second church erected in Battle Creek, 28 x 44.
 July 30, date of first *Review* printed on power steam press.
 Number of obituaries recorded in *Review* up to 1857, 75.
1859. Pamphlet printed in Holland, and tracts in French language.
 June 3, a board of three appointed to take charge of missionary funds.
1860. Seventh-day Adventist Publishing Association organized at Battle Creek, Mich., and constitution adopted Oct. 1. Legally incorporated the following year, May 3.
 Name Seventh-day Adventist first adopted, Oct. 1.
1861. Plan of church organization first published in *Review* of Oct. 15.
 Great struggle over organization, resulting in its being generally adopted. Many churches were organized in the different States this year. Some apostatized.
 Michigan State Conference organized, being the first among S. D. Adventists.
1862. General Conference organized. State Conference of New York and Minnesota organized. Second Office building erected.
1863. Conferences of Ohio and Vermont organized.
1864. Iowa Conference organized.
1866. *Health Reformer* first issued.
 Health Reform Institute founded, Sept. 5; legally incorporated Apr. 6, 1867.
1867. Maine Conference organized.
1868. First camp-meeting held at Wright, Mich., Sept. 1-7.
 Mission on Pacific coast opened.
1871. Conferences of New England, Illinois, and Wisconsin organized.
 First State T. and M. Society organized in New England.
1872. Death of Eld. Joseph Bates, March 19, aged 80 years.
 State T. and M. societies organized in New York, Michigan, and Vermont

- California Conference organized by Eld. J. White.
1873. State T. and M. societies organized in Illinois, Minnesota, and Maine.
1874. S. D. Adventist Educational Society incorporated, March.
 June 4, date of first issue of *Signs of the Times*, office at Oakland, Cal.
 Oct. 1-12, \$19,000 pledged for purpose of establishing publishing office on Pacific Coast, at Yountville (California) camp-meeting.
 Eld. J. N. Andrews sailed for Switzerland, Sept. 15.
 Conferences organized in Nebraska and Indiana, and State T. and M. Society in Indiana.
1875. April 5, Pacific S. D. A. Publishing Association incorporated.
 Kansas Conference and T. and M. Society organized.
 College at Battle Creek, Mich., opened for students.
 Dec. 25, Eld. D. T. Bourdeau left this country for Switzerland.
1876. July, publication of *Les Signes des Temps* begun at Bâle, Switzerland.
 General T. and M. Society organized.
 Kentucky and Missouri Conferences organized.
1877. May, Eld. J. G. Matteson sailed to Denmark to engage in missionary labor.
1878. April 10, Sanitarium opened for patients.
 Gen. S. S. Association organized.
 Eld. J. N. Loughborough sailed Dec. 17, to establish a mission in England.
 Tabernacle dedicated April 20.
1879. Organization of the American Health and Temperance Association.
 Eld. S. N. Haskell visits Europe.
1881. First General European Conference at Bâle, Switzerland.
 Death of Eld. James White, Aug. 6, aged 60 years.
1883. Death of Eld. J. N. Andrews, Oct. 21, aged 55 years.

THE PUBLISHING WORK.

The number of pages of Books, Pamphlets, and Tracts issued by the Publishing Association at Battle Creek, Mich., up to Oct. 1, 1882, was 250,967,415

Pages of Books for the year ending Oct. 1, 1883,	6,233,272
Pages of Pamphlets " " "	1,858,560
Pages of Tracts " " "	9,600,000

General aggregate, 263,659,247

The Periodicals issued by the above-named Association during the three years ending October, 1882, aggregated 3,051,125 copies.

The number of copies circulated during the year ending Oct. 1, 1883, is as follows:—

REVIEW AND HERALD,	346,500
YOUTH'S INSTRUCTOR,	634,584
GOOD HEALTH,	54,264
STIMME DER WAHRHEIT, (German),	27,600
SANDHEDENS TIDENDE, (Danish-Norwegian),	43,200
SANNINGENS HAROLD, (Swedish),	13,600

The number of copies of the *SIGNS OF THE TIMES*, published at Oakland, Cal., issued for the same period, was nearly or quite 1,000,000.

CHRONOLOGICAL TABLE OF IMPORTANT EVENTS.

Yrs since.	B. C.
5888—Creation of the World (Usher).....	4004
4985—Hindoo Era of Deluge	3101
4584—Beginning of Chinese History.....	2700
4282—The Deluge	2348
3905—Call of Abraham.....	1921
3784—Founding of Babylon by Nimrod, <i>cir.</i>	1900
3374—The Exodus from Egypt.....	1490
3067—The fall of Troy.....	1183
2986—Era of Cheops—Great Pyramid.....	1082
2938—David becomes King.....	1049
2846—Homer probably lived,.....	915 to 902
2762—Carthage founded.....	878
2660—The Olympic Era began.....	775
2637—Foundation of Rome; Era, A. U. C.....	753
2489—Babylonian Captivity.....	605
2471—Jerusalem taken by Nebuchad- nezzar.....	587
2422—Babylon succeeded by Medo-Persia.....	538
2393—Expulsion of the Tarquins.....	509
2364—Xerxes defeated at Thermopylae.....	480
2231—Commandment to restore and build Jerusalem.....	457
2215—Greece succeeds Medo-Persia.....	331
2045—Rome's league with Jews.....	161
1939—Caesar's invasion of Britain.....	55
1883—Birth of our Saviour.....	A. D. 4
1872—Tiberius began to reign conjoint- ly with Augustus.....	12
1890—Augustus Caesar's death.....	14
1856—Ministry of John began.....	26
1853—Crucifixion of Christ.....	31
1339—Calendar changed by Julius Caesar, year begins Jan. 1.....	45
1814—Jerusalem destroyed by Titus.....	70
1749—680,000 Jews destroyed by Ro- mans.....	135
1582—Tenth persecution.....	302
1578—London rebuilt by Romans.....	306
1561—Constantine embraced Christian- ity.....	323
1466—The Romans finally quitted Brit- ain.....	413
1401—Division of Roman Empire into ten parts completed.....	483
1351—Bishop of Rome given precedence by Justinian.....	533
1347—Basilisarius takes Rome.....	537
1346—Basilisarius subdues Ostrogoths.....	533
1346—Justinian's decree carried into ef- fect. Pope's temporal power.....	538
1313—Mahomet born.....	571
1304—Latin tongue ceases in Italy.....	580
1288—St. Augustinus arrived in England.....	596
1292—Phocas acknowledges Papal su- premacy.....	602
1274—Mahomet begins to preach.....	610
1263—Jerusalem taken by Chosroes II.....	616
1248—Jerusalem taken by Saracens.....	636
1247—Mosque built on temple site.....	637
1084—Charlemagne crowned Emperor.....	800
1057—Egbert, first king of all England.....	827
899—America discovered by Norsemen.....	985
819—Turks take Jerusalem.....	1065
788—The Crusades began.....	1066
737—Second Crusade.....	1147
697—Jerusalem taken by Saladin.....	1187

Yrs since.	A. D.
665—Third Crusade, Richard 1.....	1189
632—Fourth Crusade.....	1202
674—Crusade against Albigenses, Simon de Montfort.....	1210
669—Magna Charta granted by King John.....	1215
657—Biblis divided, Chapters, Cardinal Hugo.....	1227
650—Inquisition instituted, Dominican Monks.....	1234
636—Fifth Crusade.....	1248
619—The first Representative Parlia- ment.....	1265
585—Ottoman Empire begins.....	1299
579—Wallace captured and executed.....	1205
544—Gunpowder invented, Swartz, a Monk of Cologne.....	1340
504—Wycliffe's translation of the Bible.....	1380
444—Printing by Gutenberg, of Stras- burg.....	1440
435—Constantine Deacones succeeded to Empires of the East by per- mission of Amurath, Turkish Sultan.....	1449
431—Constantinople taken by the Turks.....	1453
422—The Bible was first printed at Mentz.....	1492
413—Caxton set up his printing press.....	1471
412—Almanacs first printed at Buda.....	1472
392—Columbus discovered America.....	1492
367—Reformation begun, Luther's 95 theses nailed to Wittenburg chapel door, Oct. 31.....	1517
363—Luther at Diet of Worms.....	1521
354—Augsburg Confession, 1st Protest- ant creed.....	1530
349—First English Bible (Coverdalis).....	1536
333—Bible divided into verses, Roht. Sappheus.....	1537
328—Archbishop Cranmer burnt.....	1556
326—Accession of Queen Elizabeth.....	1558
324—Reformation in Scotland, John Knox.....	1560
312—St. Bartholomew Massacre.....	1572
297—Mary Queen of Scots beheaded.....	1587
292—Presbyterian Church Government.....	1592
287—Union of Crowns, (England and Scotland).....	1603
277—First English Settlement in Amer- ica, Jamestown, Va.....	1607
King James' version.....	1607-1611
236—Charles I. beheaded Jan. 30.....	1649
231—Oliver Cromwell, Lord Protector.....	1653
224—The Monarchy restored.....	1660
221—Vienna besieged by Turks.....	1663
206—Habeas Corpus Act passed.....	1679
202—Philadelphia founded.....	1680
183—Prussia first made a Kingdom.....	1701
177—Legislative union of England and Scotland.....	1707
128—Black Hole Suffocation in Calcutta.....	1756
111—Tea destroyed in Boston Harbor.....	1773
111—Jesuits supported by Pope's Bull.....	1773
109—First American Battle at Lex- ington.....	1775
106—American Flag first used.....	1776
108—Declaration of Independence, July 4.....	1776
104—Dark-day, May 19.....	1780

Yrs since.	A. D.
103—Cornwallis Surrenders at Yorktown	1781
102—Independence of U. S. acknowledged	1782
96—First Settlement in Australia	1788
91—Louis XVI. of France executed	1793
86—Papal Supremacy ended	1798
84—Pius VII. restored, July 25, by Bonaparte	1800
82—Catholicism re-established in France	1802
80—Bonaparte made Emperor of France	1804
79—Battle of Trafalgar, Death of Nelson	1805
77—Gas first introduced	1807
72—French Expedition to Russia	1812
69—Battle of Waterloo, June 18	1815
54—First Railroad opened	1830
54—Revolution in France, Charles X. Expelled	1830
50—Lucifer Matches came into use	1834
46—Electric Telegraph first constructed	1838
40—Great Advent movement, 1840 to 1844	1844
40—Tenth day of seventh month, Oct. 22	1844
38—War between U. S. and Mexico	1846

Yrs since.	A. D.
36—Modern Spiritualism began Mar. 31, near Rochester	1848
36—Revolution in France, L. Philippe Expelled	1848
36—Gold first discovered in California	1848
33—First International Exhibition	1851
32—Louis Napoleon, Emperor of France	1852
30—Immaculate Conception Decreed, Dec. 8	1854
29—Capture of Sebastopol	1855
25—John Brown Executed at Charles-ton	1859
24—Garibaldi's entrance into Naples	1860
23—Ft. Sumpter captured	1861
21—Emancipation proclaimed	1863
19—Lee's surrender to Grant, Apr. 12	1865
19—Lincoln assassinated, Apr. 14	1865
18—Battle of Sadowa, July 3	1866
17—Alaska ceded by Russia to U. S.	1867
14—Infatibility decreed, July 21	1870
14—Capitulation of Sedan	1870
13—The German Empire re-established	1871
3—Assassination of Czar of Russia	1881
3—Assassination of Garfield, July 3	1881
2—244 Earthquakes during the year 1881	1881
2—English Expedition to Egypt	1882

ACCIDENTS, ETC., OF 1883.

	Deaths.		Deaths.
Jan. 10—Ohio Shaken by an Earthquake		Nov. 6—Steamer Iris, off cape Villard, Spain	35
" 10—Newhall House fire, Milwaukee, Wis.	70	" —Mine Explosion, Lancashire, Eng.	67
" —Circus fire in Poland	270	" 13—Oyster fleet, Chesapeake Bay	25
" 17—22 Shocks of Earthquake, Murcia, Spain		" 18—Steamer Hymethus, North Sea	22
July 28—Earthquake, Casamicciola, near Naples, Italy	6,000	" —Propeller Manitowish, Lake Superior	20
" 29—Mine Explosion, Caltanissetta, Sicily	35	" —Steamer collision, Lake Geneva, Suisse	20
Aug. 21—Cyclone, Rochester, Minn., and elsewhere	24	" 26—Fishing schooners, Gloucester, Mass.	75
" 23—Fall of scaffold, Bavaria	23	Jan. —Mara, Switzerland, destroyed by earthquake	unk'n.
" 28—Awful Earthquake in Malay Archipelago, estimated	170,000	" 22—Powder explosion near Oakland, Cal.	26
" 31—2,000 fishing dories capsized off Newfoundland	80	" 26—Loss of Cimbrina	434
" —Steamship Ludwig lost, never heard from	70	" —General floods throughout U. S. and Europe, —50,000 homeless	unk'n.
Sept. 2—R. R. collision, Steglitz, Germany	40	" Mine flooded, Sydney, Australia	2
" —Bridge fell, Westphal, Germany	25	Feb. 1—Steamer Ansonia wrecked off Tripoli	20
" 11—Fishing dories lost off Newfoundland	97	" 2—Panic, wool factory, Bombay, B. I.	23
" —Greely Exploring party given up for lost	22	" 8—Steamer Kenmare Castle foundered	32
" 26—Hurricane at Nassau, Tex.	50	" 17—Cave-in Diamond Coal Mine, Joliet, Ill.	77
" 29—Powder explosion, Steges station, Cal.	40	Mar. 10—Hull and Yarmouth fishing fleets, several boats lost	135
Oct. 11—Laestrella, Spain, inundated —Church panic, Ziwouka, Russia	40	" 11—Steamer Navarro foundered	46
" 17—Earthquake in Syria	10,000	" 18—Steamer Dunetaffnage, off Aberdeenshire	25
" —Earthquake in Grecian Archipelago	200	" 26—Snow avalanche, Mt. Ararat	150
" 18—Mine Explosion, Yorkshire, Eng.	20		

RELIGIOUS DENOMINATIONS.

79

	Deaths.		Deaths.
Apr. 1—Six fishing smacks off Yarmouth wrecked.....	40	" —Steamer Auk wrecked in English Channel.....	21
" 2—Boiler explosion, St. Dizier, France.....	31	" Schooner Mary Ann Hulbut, Lake Superior.....	20
" 6—Powder explosion, Rome, It., many fatally injured.....	40	" 18—Six ships, 18 coasters, in Mediterranean.....	100
" 26—Collision, Steamers Count Aberdeen and British Commerce.....	25	" 21—Steamer St. Augustine burned.....	38
" Mine Explosion, Besseges, France.....	20	This list for 1883 does not include the many accidents and deaths resulting from the above-named and similar causes, when the number reported was less than twenty.	
May 4—Steamer Grappler burned off Seymour's Narrows....	70	The following, from the daily <i>Inter Ocean</i> of Dec. 12, 1883, gives the number of deaths, so far as known, for each month of 1883, as follows: "January, 966; February, 360; March, 423; April, 551; May, 254; June, 348; July, 4,468; August, 175,306; September, 355; October, 10,432; November, 474; December, 370. Total, to Dec. 23, 194,367."	
" —Cyclone, Illinois, Ohio, and Missouri.....	22	This does not include the 38,000 who have died of cholera in Egypt and India. Nearly 2,509 murders have occurred in U. S. alone during the past year, and 1,550 suicides.	
" 18—Cyclone, Illinois and Wisconsin.....	54	* Probably too small by 2,000.	
June 1—Boat capsized. Oleggio, It..	22	† Estimated by good authority to be 25,000 too small.	
" 17—Panic, school children, Sunderland, Eng.....	202	‡ "Includes only disasters, calamities, and accidents, and in these only such are mentioned as resulted in the loss of three or more lives." "No account is made of the loss of life by war, pestilence, famine, crime, or suicide, but in these ways untold thousands made a miserable exit from the world."— <i>Inter Ocean</i> .	
" 25—Collision, steamers Huronia and Altari, off Portland.....	25		
July 4—Overturning steamer Daphne, Renfrew, Scotland....	150		
" 13—Portuguese bark Pimpoa wrecked.....	30		
" 15—Firs, Siptozentnikle, Hungary.....	20		
" 24—Breaking of pier, near Baltimore, Md.....	70		
" 27—Railway collision, Carlyon, N. Y.....	22		
Dec. 11—Cyclone off British Islands,	27		
" 13—Seven vessels wrecked off U. S. east coast.....	70		

RELIGIOUS DENOMINATIONS IN THE UNITED STATES.

	Churches.	Ministers.	Communicants.
Adventists.....	1,344	775	91,769
Baptists.....	37,156	26,545	3,336,553
Congregationalists.....	3,936	3,723	387,619
Friends.....	392	200	96,000
German Ev. Ch.....	550	430	80,000
Lutherans.....	6,130	3,429	785,987
Methodists.....	41,271	24,485	3,943,875
Mennonites.....	500	450	80,000
Moravians.....	84	70	9,928
New Jerusalem.....	87	92	3,994
Presbyterians.....	11,753	3,834	966,437
Protestant Episcopal.....	3,109	2,664	351,699
Reformed.....	1,942	1,320	243,825
Roman Catholic.....	6,241	6,546	6,832,954
Schwendfeldians.....			700
Unitarians.....	362	424	20,000
Universalists.....	719	718	36,238
Total in United States.....	115,606	81,710	17,267,578

Independent Almanac.

POSTAL GUIDE.

FIRST-CLASS MATTER.

Matter which is wholly in writing, sealed or unsealed, printed commercial papers, filled out in writing, having the nature of a personal correspondence, or being the expression of a man's value, such as notes, drafts, receipts, executed deeds, and insurance policies, manuscript for publication, when unaccompanied by proof-sheets, reproductions by the copygraph, and similar processes, which are in the nature of personal correspondence, or imitating written matter, and all packages, the contents of which cannot be ascertained without destroying the wrapper. Postage, 2 cents each half ounce, or far each fraction above half an ounce. On local or drop letters at offices where there is no free delivery by carriers, 1 cent. Weight of packages not limited. Postal cards, 1 cent. Registered letters, 10 cents in addition to proper postage.

SECOND-CLASS MATTER.

Regular Publications.—This class includes all newspapers, periodicals, or matter exclusively in print and regularly issued, at stated periods, from a known office of publication, or news agency. Postage, 2 cents a pound or fraction thereof. Weight of packages not limited.

THIRD-CLASS MATTER.

Mail matter of the third class embraces books, (printed and blank), transient newspapers and periodicals, circulars and corrected proof-sheets, and manuscript copy accompanying the same, hand-bills, posters, chromo-lithographs, engravings, heliotype, lithographs, photographic and stereoscopic views with title written or printed thereon, printed blanks, printed cards; and postage shall be prepaid thereon at the rate of 1 cent for each two ounces or fractional part thereof.

Upon matter of the third class, or upon the wrapper enclosing the same, the sender may write his own name or address thereon, with the word "from" above and preceding the same, and in either case may make simple marks intended to designate a word or passage of the text to which it is desired to call attention. Here may be placed upon the cover or blank leaves of any book or of any printed matter of the third class a simple manuscript dedication or inscription that does not partake of the nature of a personal correspondence.

All packages of matter of the third class must be so wrapped with open sides or ends, that their contents may be readily examined by postmasters.

FOURTH-CLASS MATTER.

Mailable matter of the fourth class embraces blank cards, card-board, and other flexible material, flexible patterns, letter-envelopes and letter-paper, merchandise, models, ornamented paper, sample cards, samples of ores, metals, minerals, seeds, cuttings, bulbs, roots, scions, drawings, plans, designs, original paintings in oil or water-colors, and any other matter not included in the first, second, or third classes, and which is not in its form or nature liable to destroy, deface, or otherwise damage the contents of the mail-bag, or harm the person of any one engaged in the postal service, or matter excluded by sections 8303 and 8304 Revised Statutes to-wit, obscene matter and matter concerning lotteries. Postage rate thereon, one cent for each ounce or fractional part thereof.

Other articles of the fourth class, which, unless properly secured, might destroy, deface, or otherwise damage the contents of the mail-bag, or harm the person of any one engaged in the postal service, may be transmitted in the mails when they conform to the following conditions: 1. They must be placed in a bag, box, or removable envelope made of paper, cloth, or parchment; 2. Such bag, box, or envelope must again be placed in a box or tube made of metal or some hard wood, with sliding clasp, or screw lid; 3. In case of articles liable to break, the inside box, bag, or envelope must be surrounded by sawdust, cotton, or spongy substance; 4. In case of sharp pointed instruments, the points must be capped or encased; and when they have blades, such blades must be bound with wire; 5. The whole must be capable of easy inspection. Seeds or other articles not prohibited, which are liable from their form or nature to loss or damage unless specially protected, may be put up in sealed envelopes, provided such envelopes are made of material sufficiently transparent to show the contents clearly without opening.

Upon any package of matter of the fourth class the sender may write or print his own name and address, preceded by the word "from," and there may also be written or printed the number and names of the articles inclosed; and the sender thereof may write or print upon or attach to any such articles, by tag or label, a mark, number, name, or letter, for purpose of identification.

Fourth-class matter may also be registered, and must be fully prepaid.

RATES OF POSTAGE.

Foreign rates to all following countries and places, which are in the Universal Postal Union, the postage on letters is 5 cents for each half ounce or fraction thereof, 2 cents for each postal card, and 1 cent for each two ounces of newspapers: Argentine Republic, Austria and Hungary, Bahamas, Barbadoes, Belgium, Bermuda, Brazil, Bulgaria, Ceylon, China via Hong-Kong, Chili, Cuba, Denmark and Danish Colonies, Ecuador, Egypt, Falkland Islands, France and French Colonies, Germany, Great Britain, Greece, Greenland, Guatemala, Hayti, Holland or Netherlands and Netherlands Colonies, Honduras, Hong-Kong, India (British), Ireland, Italy, Jamaica, Japan, Liberia, Luxembourg, Malacca, Mauritius, Mexico, Montenegro, New Zealand, Norway, Paraguay, Persia, Persia, Portugal and Portuguese Colonies, Roumania, Russia, Salvador, Serbia, Singapore, Spain and Spanish Colonies, Straits Settlements, S. Vincent (W. I.), Sweden, Switzerland, Trinidad, Turkey, United States of Columbia, Uruguay, Venezuela.

Postage to countries and places not in Postal Union, prepayment compulsory.—To the following foreign places the postage on letters and newspapers is as follows:—

Letters not exceeding $\frac{1}{2}$ ounce to Cape of Good Hope, 15 cents; newspapers, 8 cents. Letters not exceeding $\frac{1}{2}$ ounce to China via Southampton, 13 cents; newspapers, 4 cents. Letters not exceeding $\frac{1}{2}$ ounce to Australia, except New South Wales, Queensland, and Victoria, via San Francisco, 5 cents; newspapers, 2 cents. Letters not exceeding $\frac{1}{2}$ ounce to New South Wales, Queensland, Victoria, and New Zealand, via San Francisco, 12 cents; newspapers, 2 cents. Letters not exceeding $\frac{1}{2}$ ounce to Canada and British North American Provinces, except New Foundland, 3 cents; newspapers, 1 cent.